

Chapter 7

Wireless and Mobile Networks

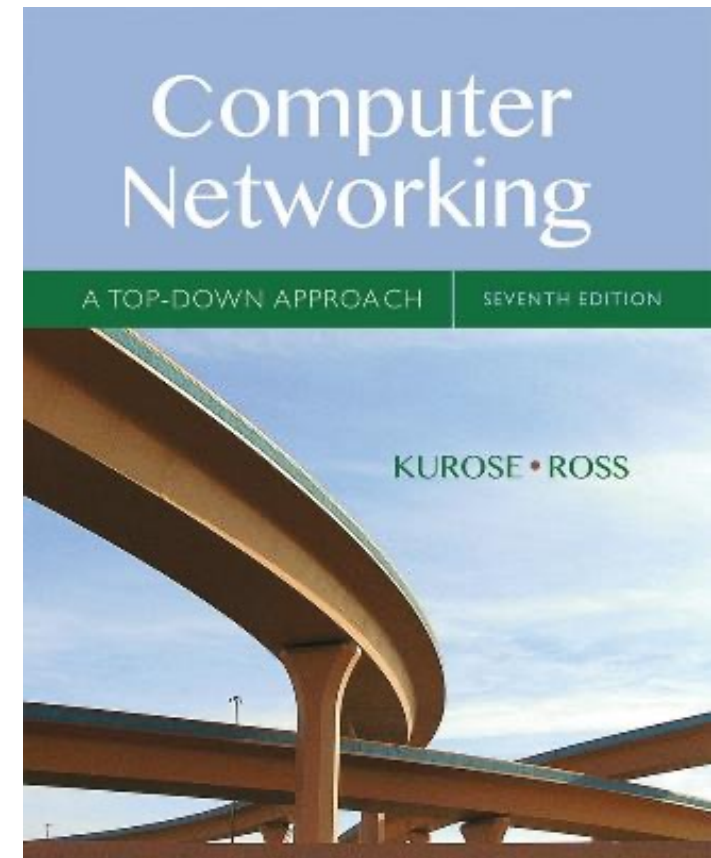
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Computer Networking: A Top Down Approach

7th edition

Jim Kurose, Keith Ross

Pearson/Addison Wesley

April 2016

Ch. 6: Wireless and Mobile Networks

Background:

- # wireless (mobile) phone subscribers now exceeds # wired phone subscribers (10-to-1 2019)!
- # wireless Internet-connected devices equals # wireline Internet-connected devices
 - laptops, Internet-enabled phones promise anytime untethered Internet access
- more mobile-broadband-connected devices than fixed-broadband-connected devices (5-1 in 2019)!
 - 4G/5G cellular networks now embracing Internet protocol stack, including SDN
- two important (but different) challenges
 - *wireless*: communication over wireless link
 - *mobility*: handling the mobile user who changes point of attachment to network



Chapter 7 outline

7.1 Introduction

Wireless

7.2 Wireless links, characteristics

- CDMA

7.3 IEEE 802.11 wireless LANs (“Wi-Fi”)

7.4 Cellular Internet Access

- architecture
- standards (e.g., 3G, LTE, 4G and 5G)

Mobility

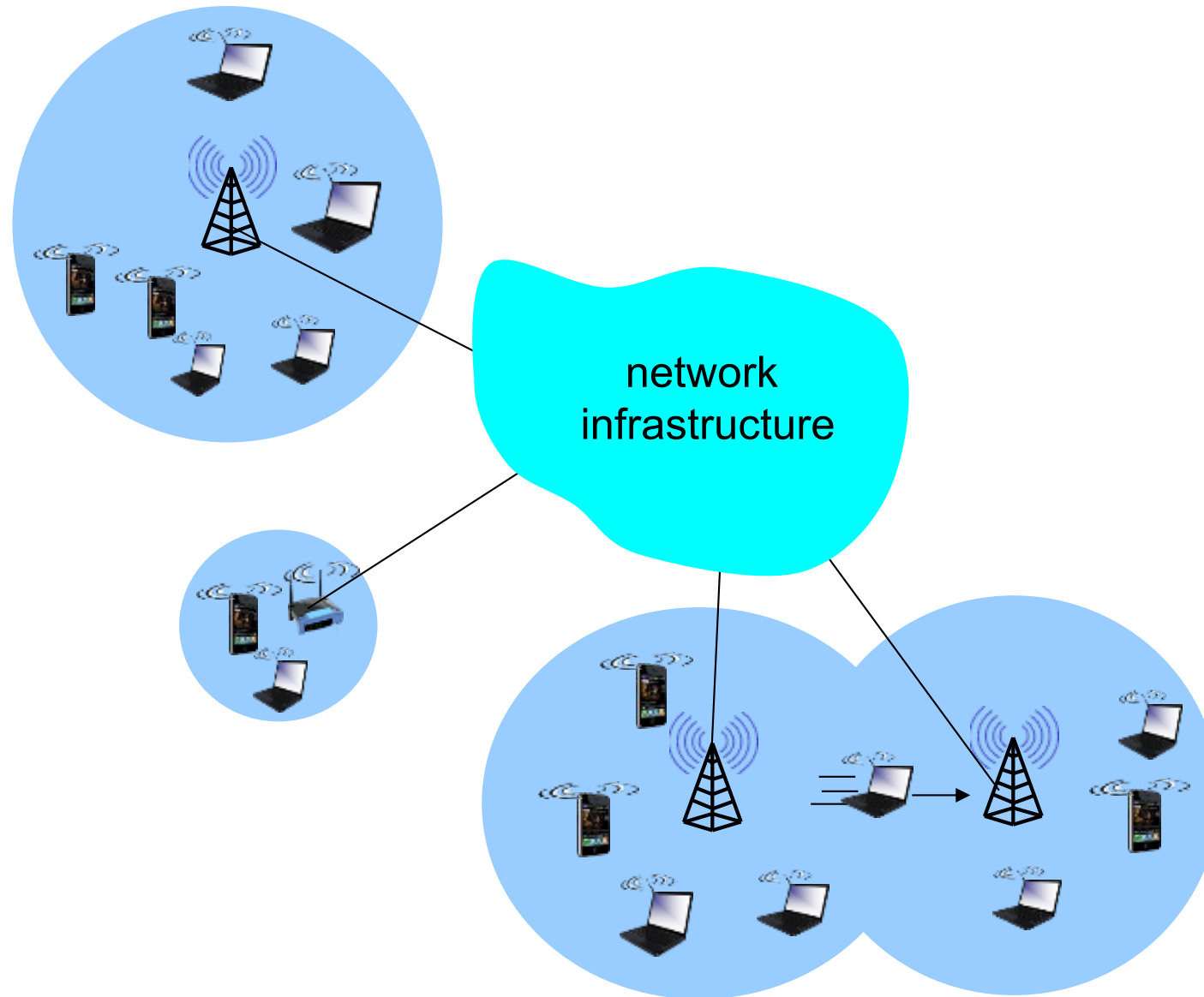
7.5 Principles: addressing and routing to mobile users

7.6 Mobile IP

7.7 Handling mobility in cellular networks

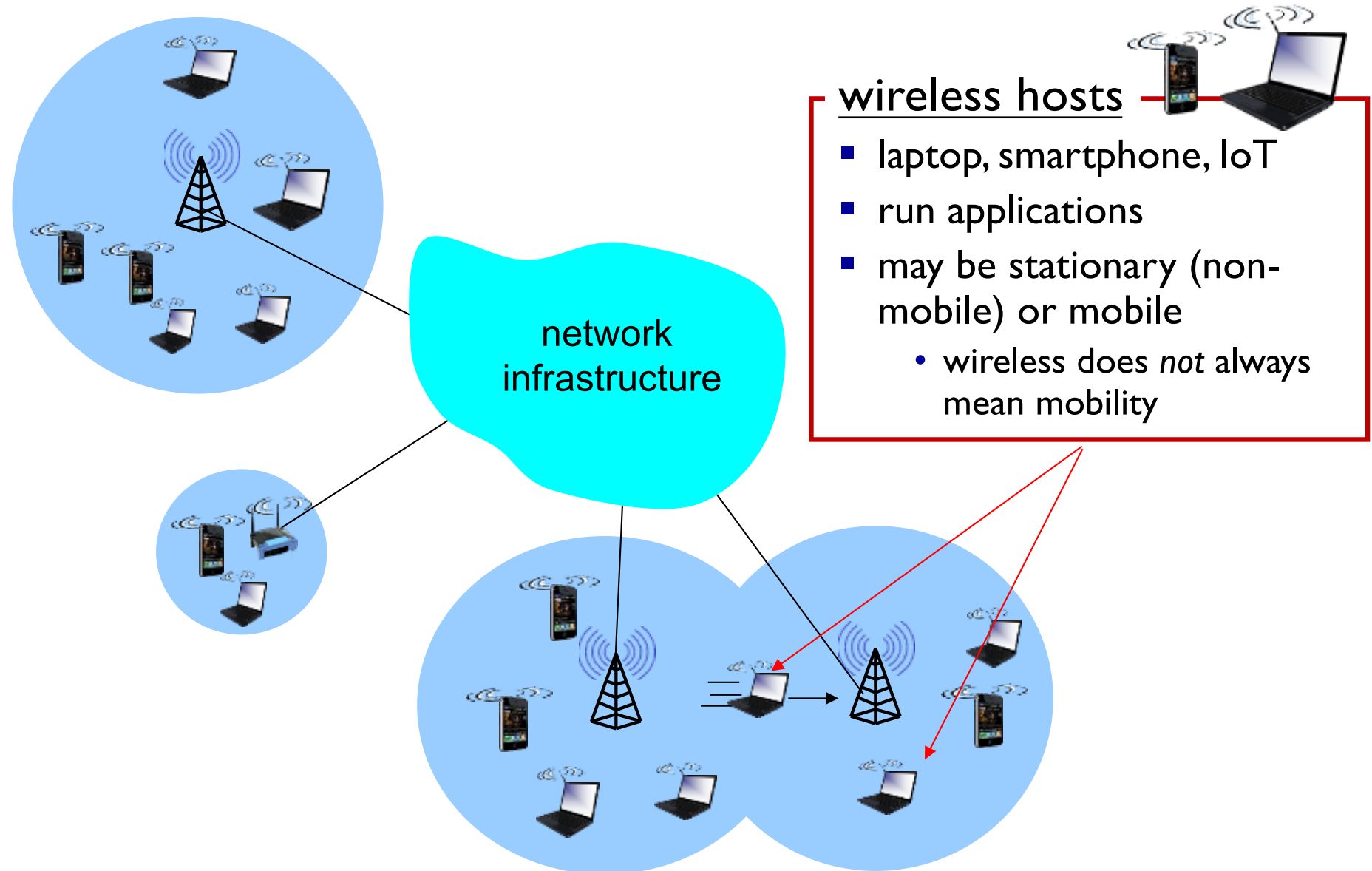
7.8 Mobility and higher-layer protocols

Elements of a wireless network

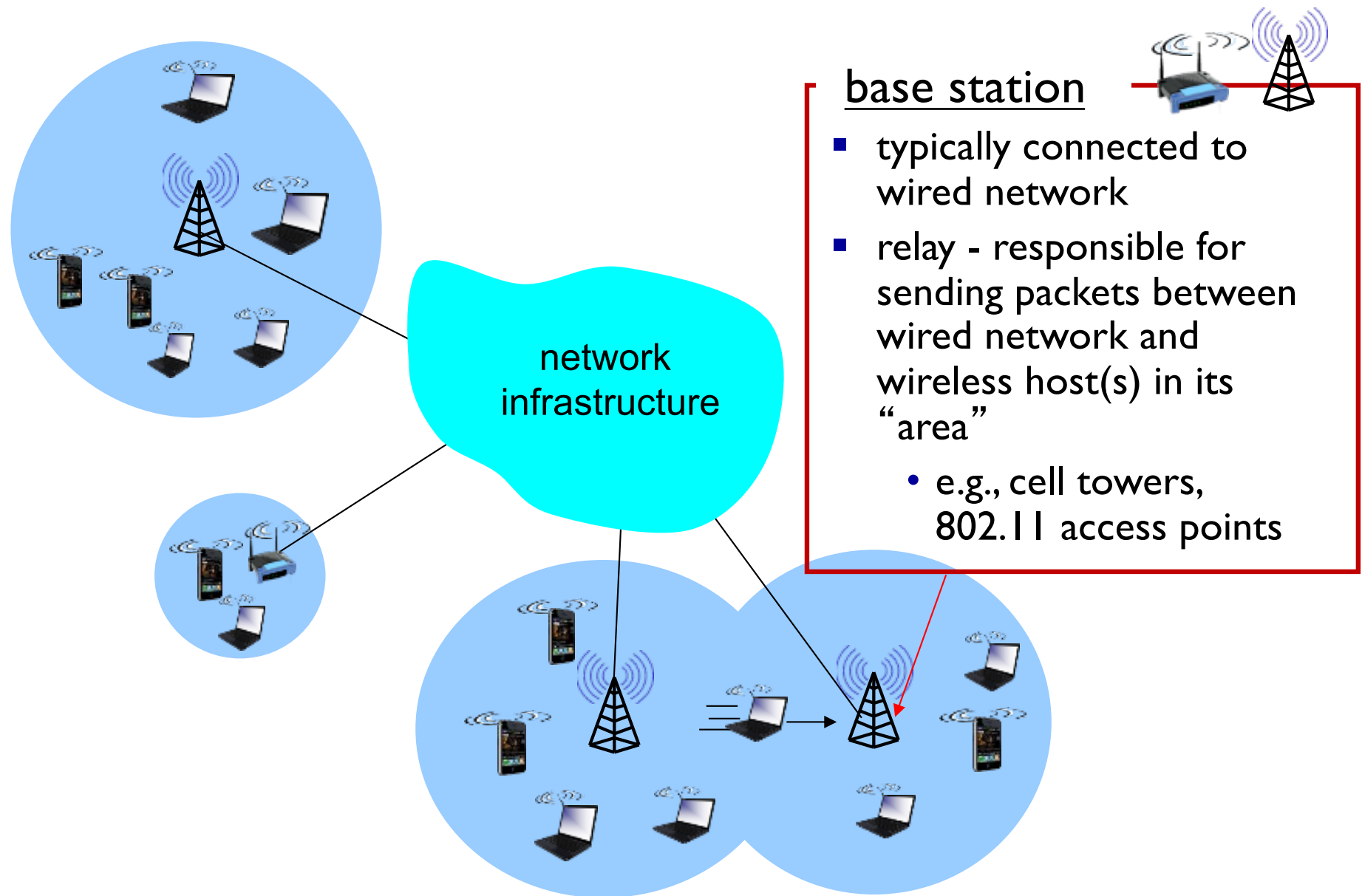




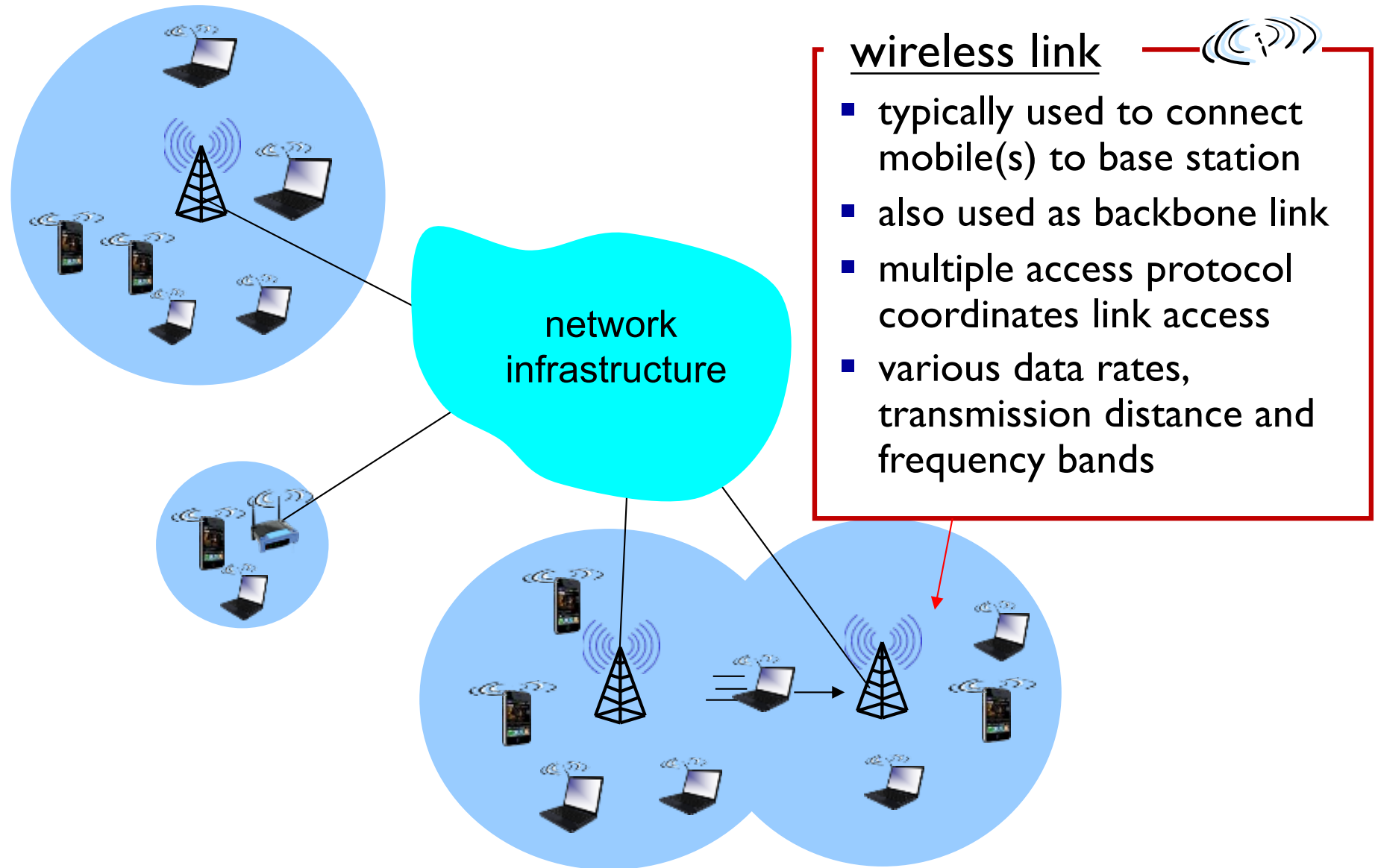
Elements of a wireless network



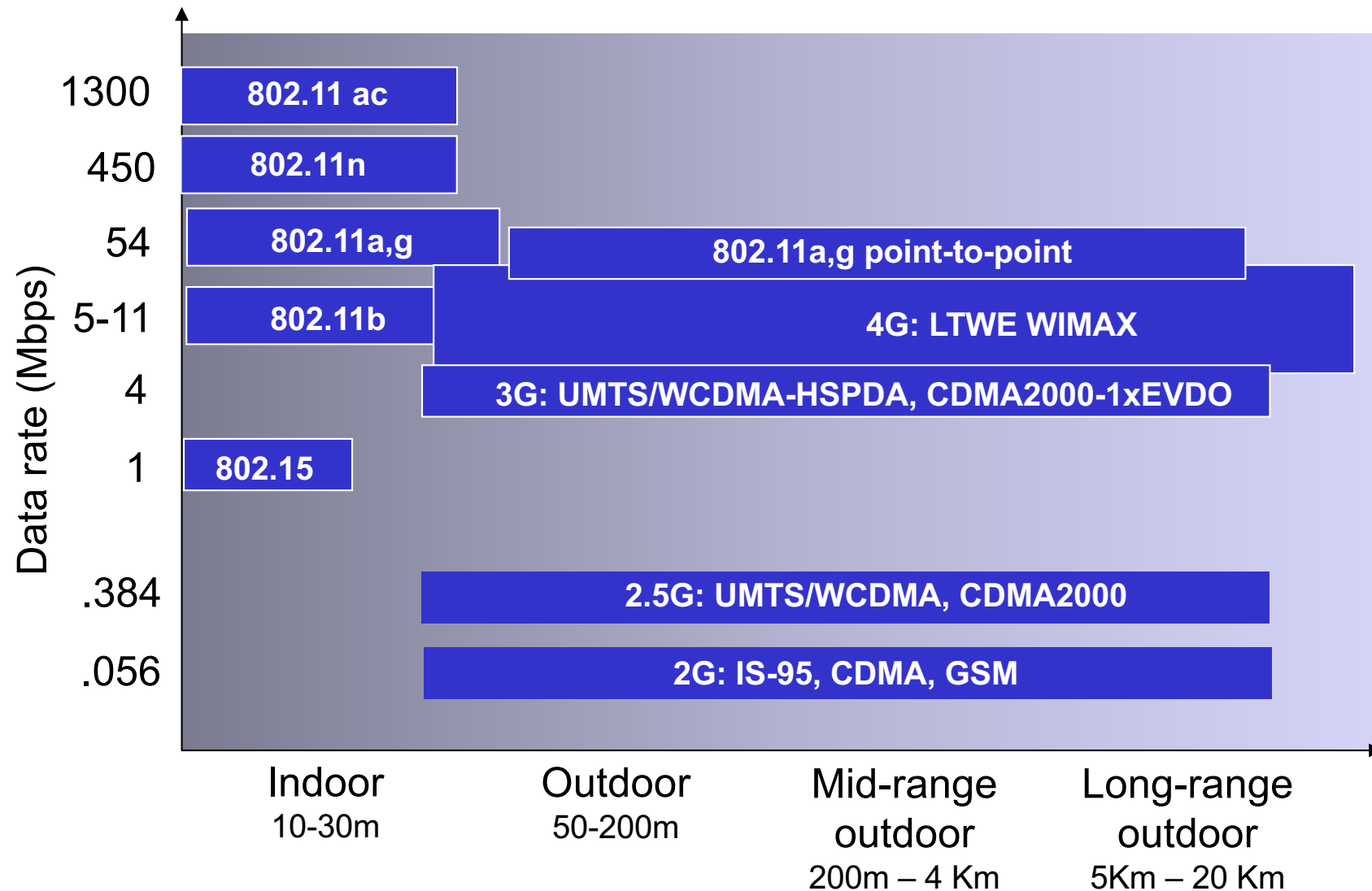
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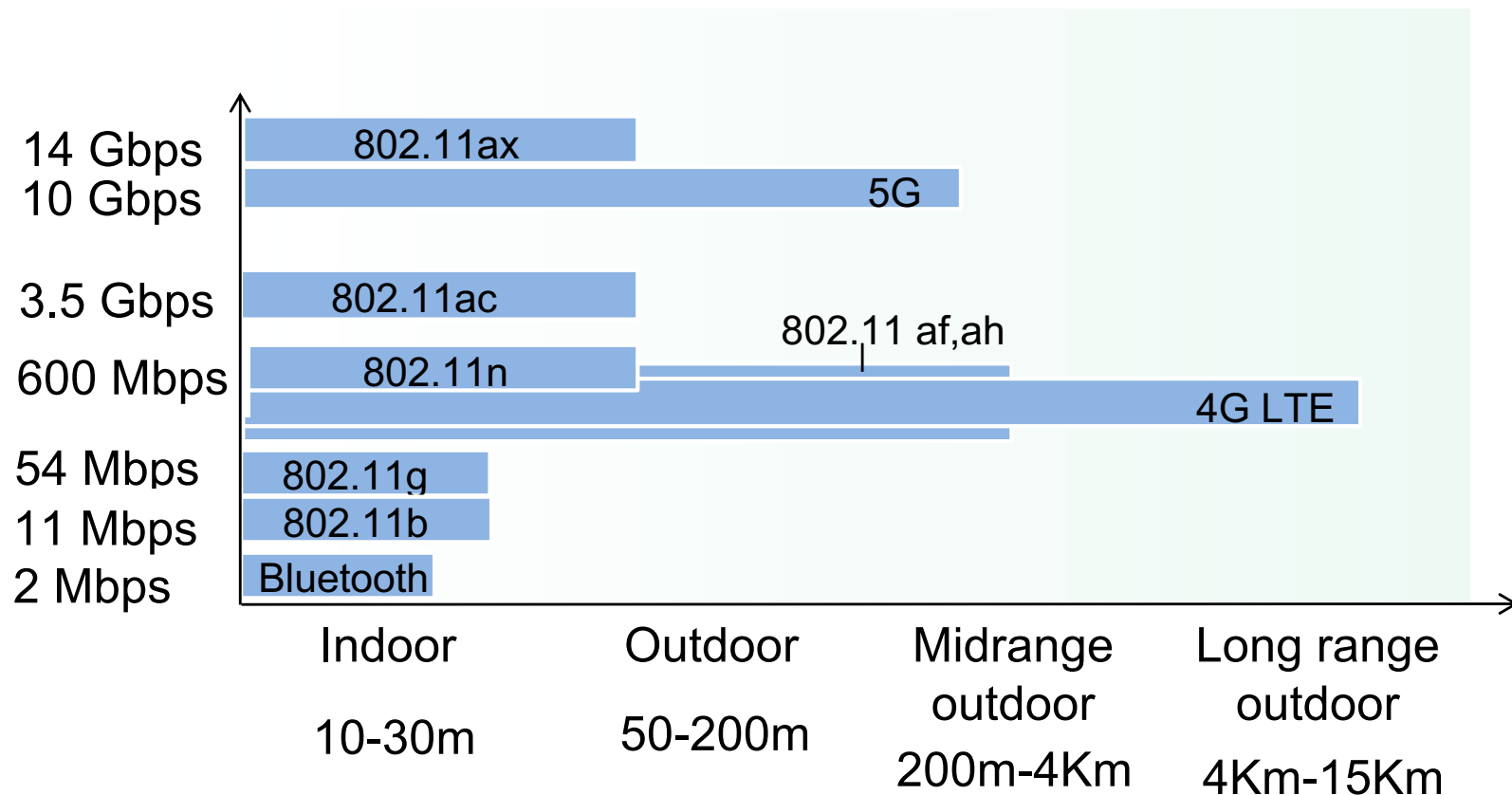


Characteristics of selected wireless links

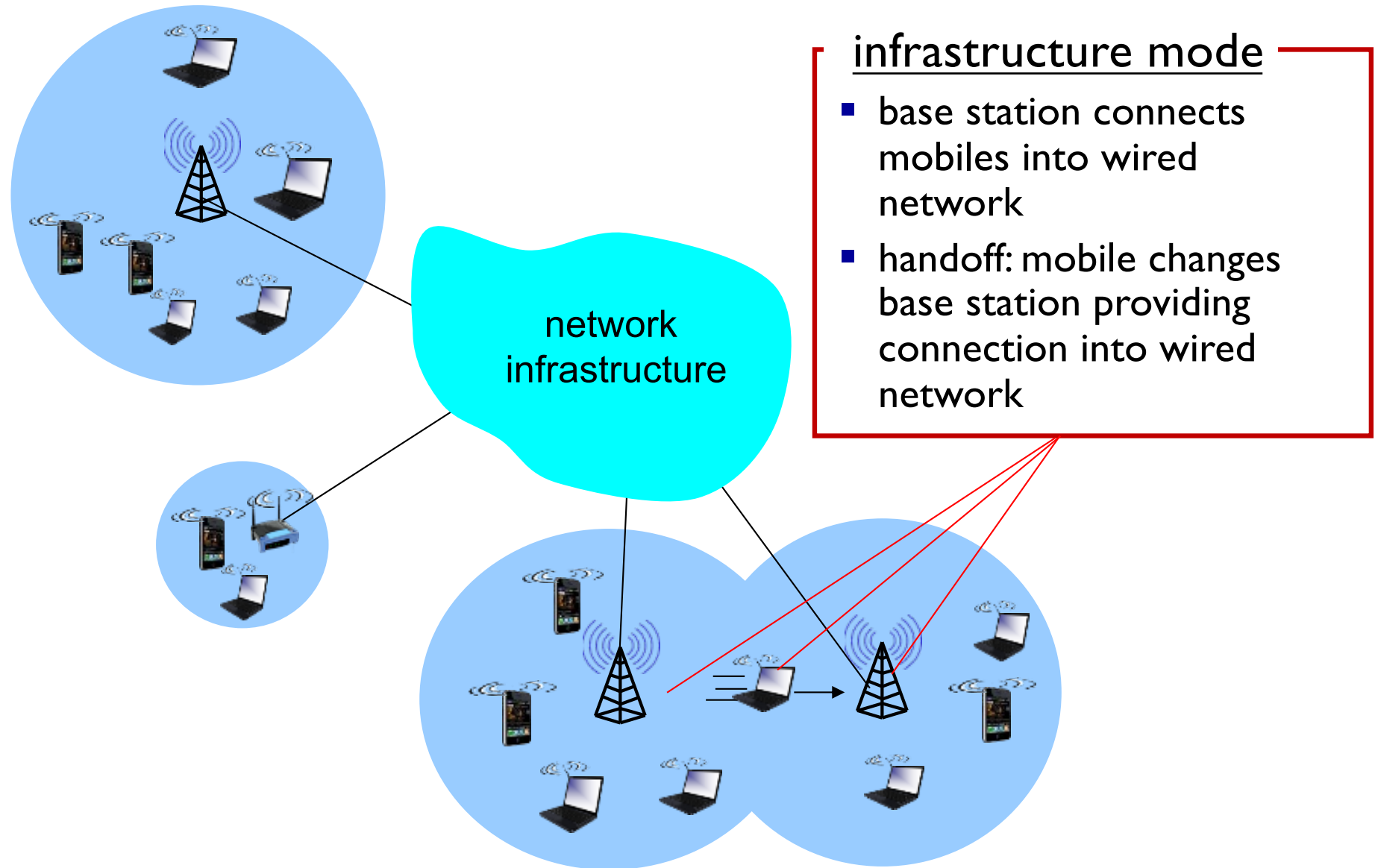




Characteristics of selected wireless links

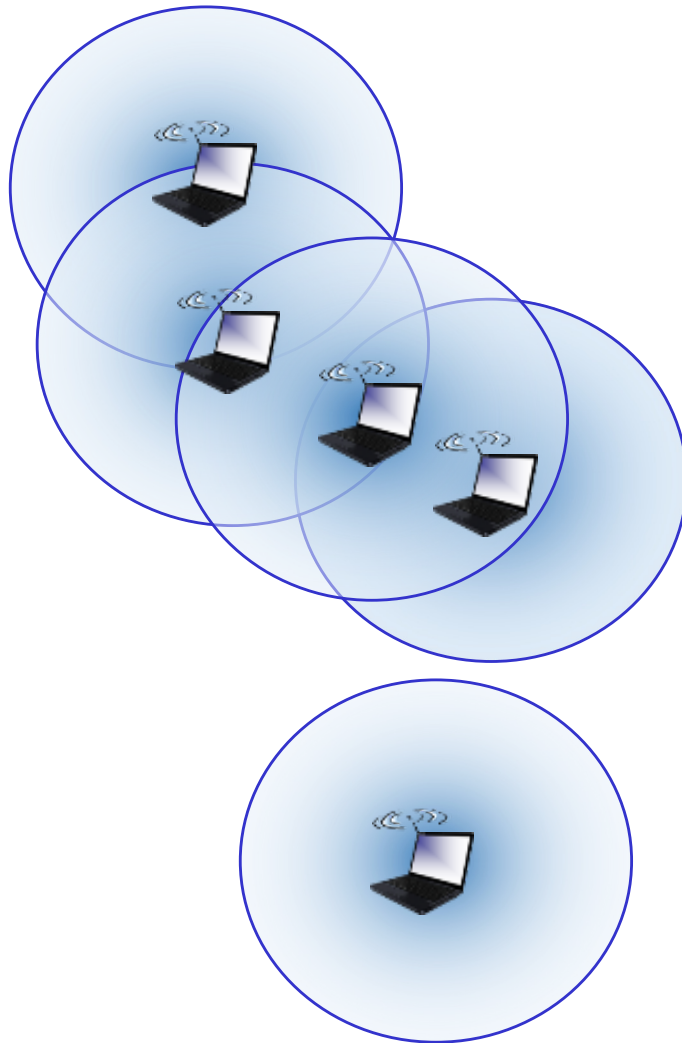


Elements of a wireless network



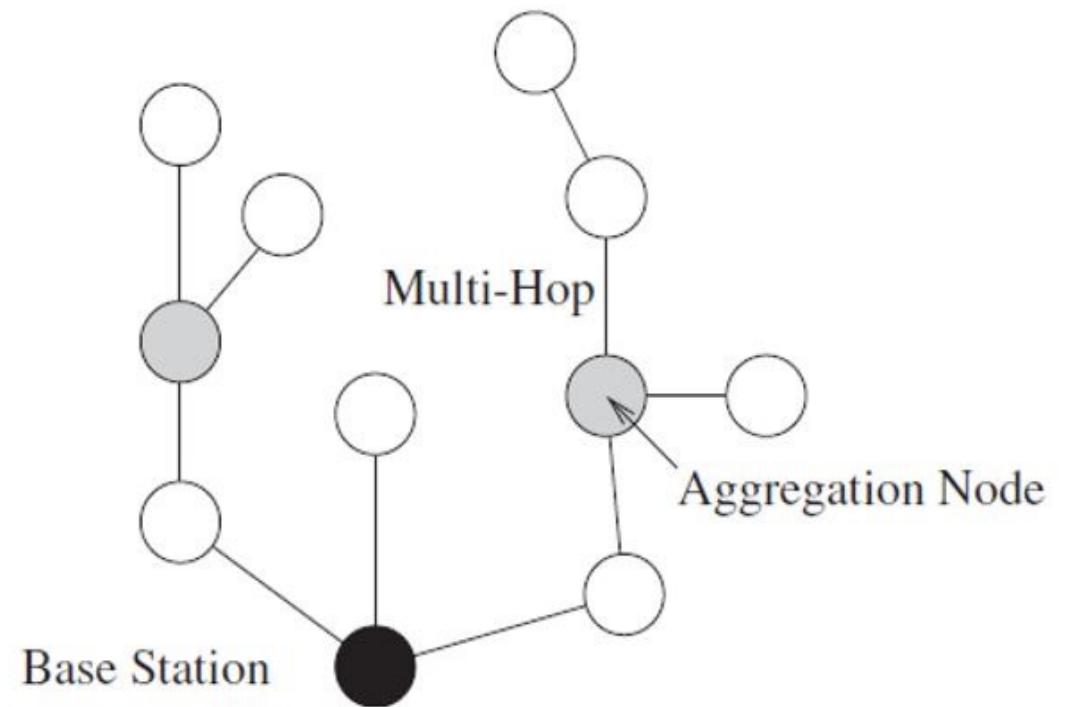
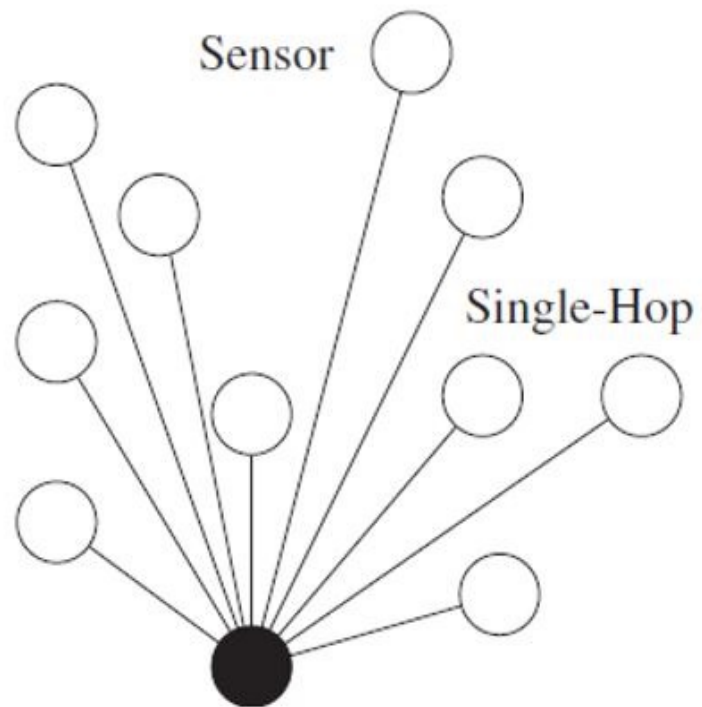


Elements of a wireless network



ad hoc mode

- no base stations
- nodes can only transmit to other nodes within link coverage
- nodes organize themselves into a network: route among themselves



Single Hop vs. Multiple Hop

Wireless network taxonomy

	single hop	multiple hops
infrastructure (e.g., APs)	host connects to base station (WiFi, WiMAX, cellular) which connects to larger Internet	host may have to relay through several wireless nodes to connect to larger Internet: <i>mesh net</i>
no infrastructure	no base station, no connection to larger Internet (Bluetooth, ad hoc nets)	no base station, no connection to larger Internet. May have to relay to reach other a given wireless node MANET, VANET

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Wireless Link Characteristics (I)

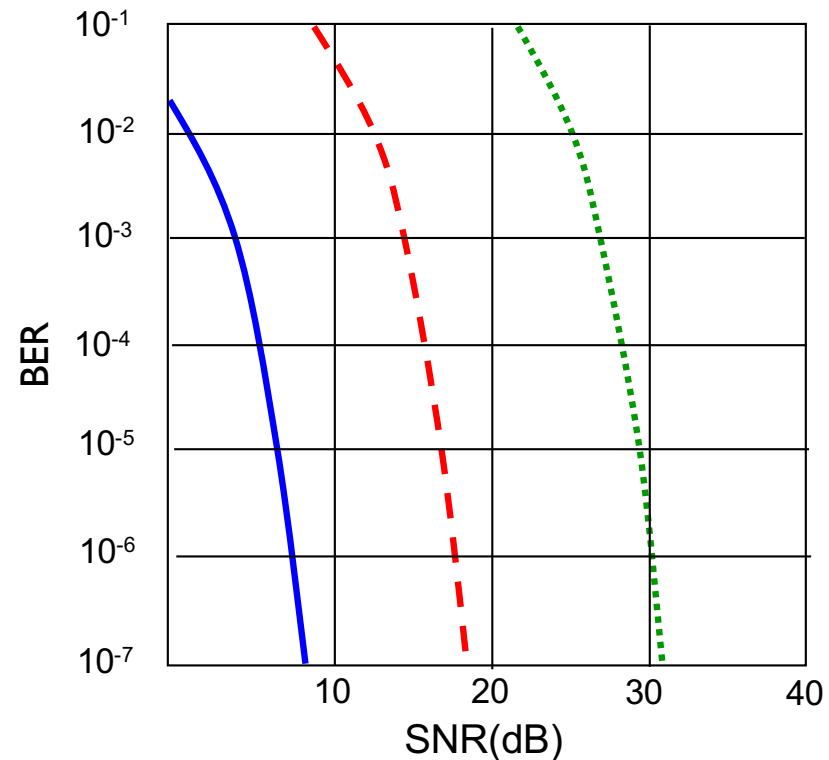
important differences from wired link

- *decreased signal strength*: radio signal attenuates as it propagates through matter (path loss)
- *interference from other sources*: standardized wireless network frequencies (e.g., 2.4 GHz) shared by many (e.g., WiFi, cellular, motors): interference
- *multipath propagation*: radio signal reflects off objects ground, arriving to the destination at slightly different times

.... make communication across (even a point to point) wireless link much more “difficult”

Wireless Link Characteristics (2)

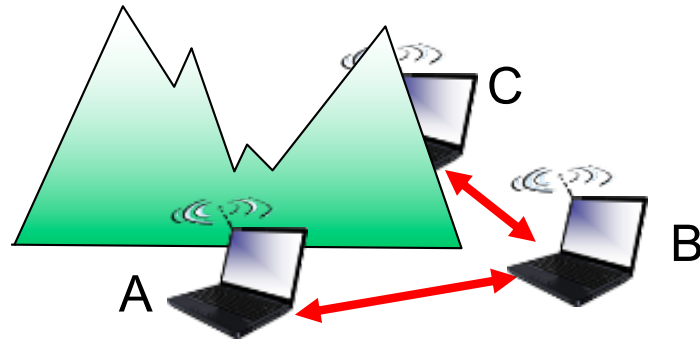
- SNR: signal-to-noise ratio
 - larger SNR – easier to extract signal from noise (a “good thing”)
- *SNR versus BER tradeoffs*
 - *given physical layer*: increase power $\rightarrow$ increase SNR $\rightarrow$ decrease BER
 - *given SNR*: choose physical layer that meets BER requirement, giving highest throughput
 - SNR may change with mobility: dynamically adapt physical layer (modulation technique, rate)



- QAM256 (8 Mbps)
- - - QAM16 (4 Mbps)
- BPSK (1 Mbps)

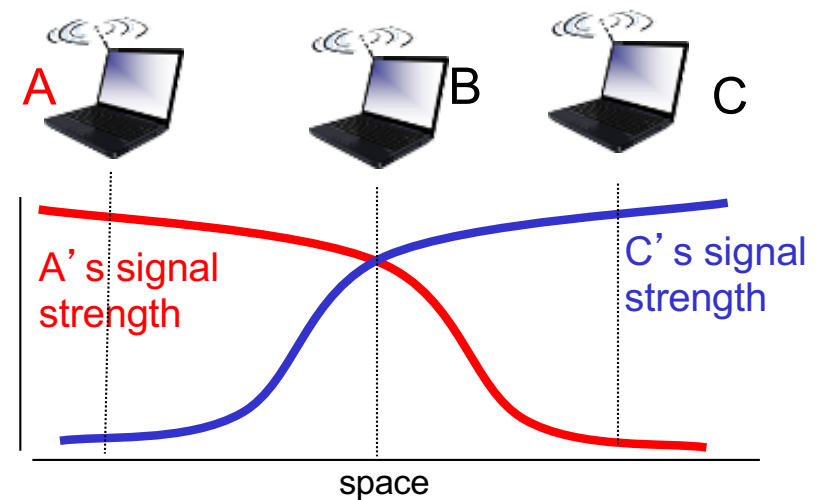
Wireless network characteristics

Multiple wireless senders and receivers create additional problems (beyond multiple access):



Hidden terminal problem

- B, A hear each other
- B, C hear each other
- A, C can not hear each other means A, C unaware of their interference at B



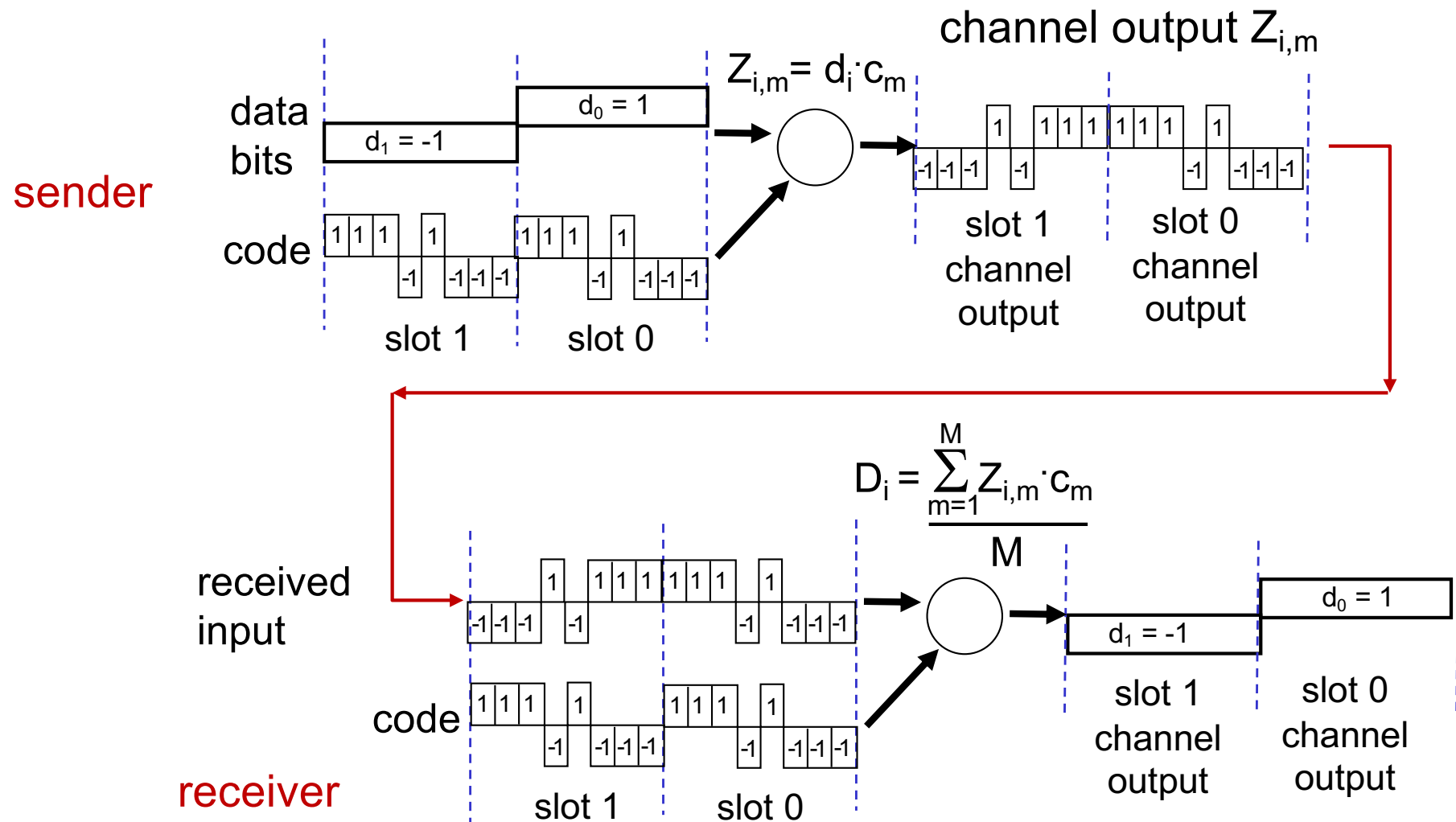
Signal attenuation:

- B, A hear each other
- B, C hear each other
- A, C can not hear each other interfering at B

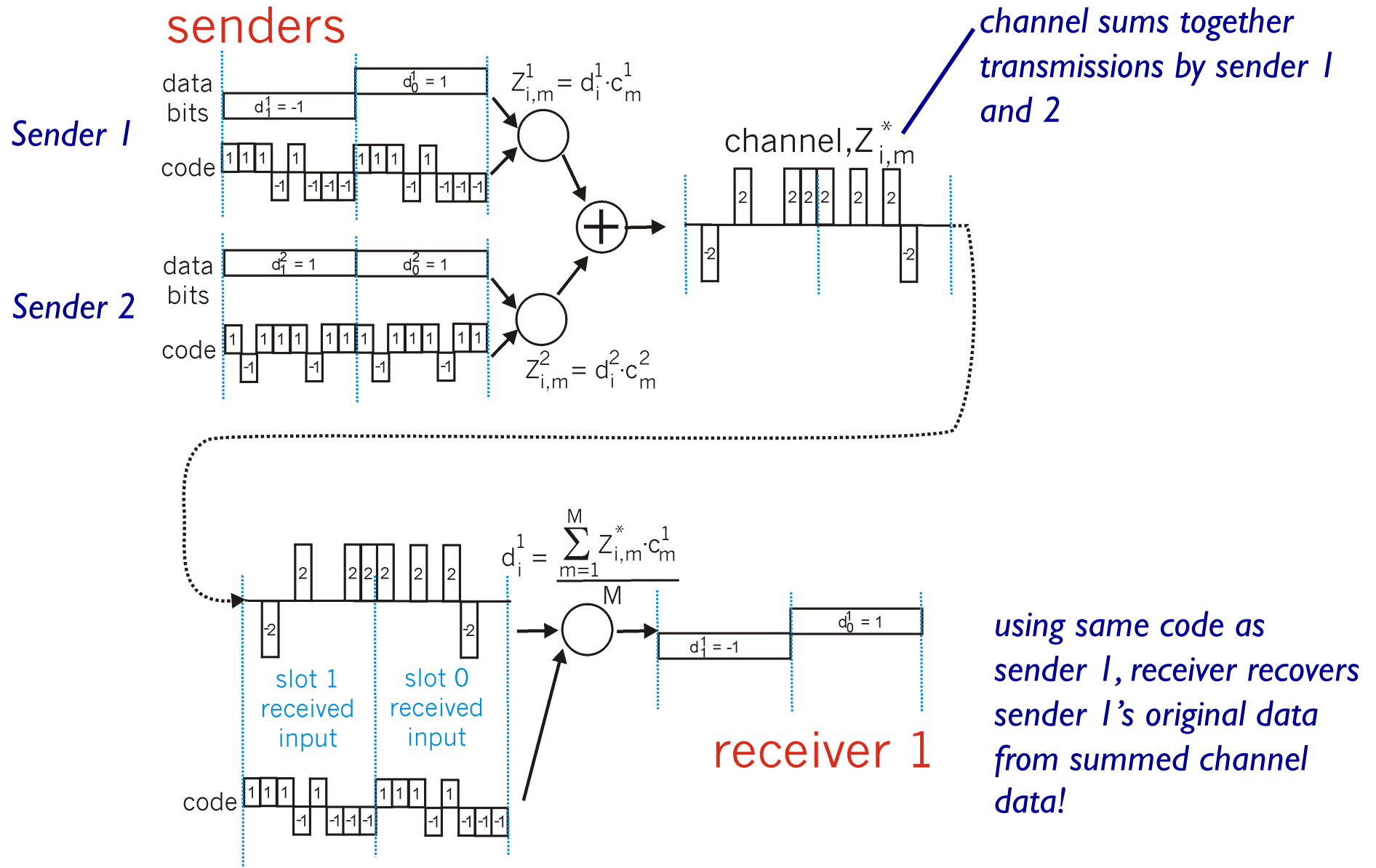
Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA)

- unique “code” assigned to each user; i.e., code set partitioning
 - all users share same frequency, but each user has own “chipping” sequence (i.e., code) to encode data
 - allows multiple users to “coexist” and transmit simultaneously with minimal interference (if codes are “orthogonal”)
- *encoded signal* = (original data) X (chipping sequence)
- *decoding*: inner-product of encoded signal and chipping sequence

CDMA encode/decode



CDMA: two-sender interference



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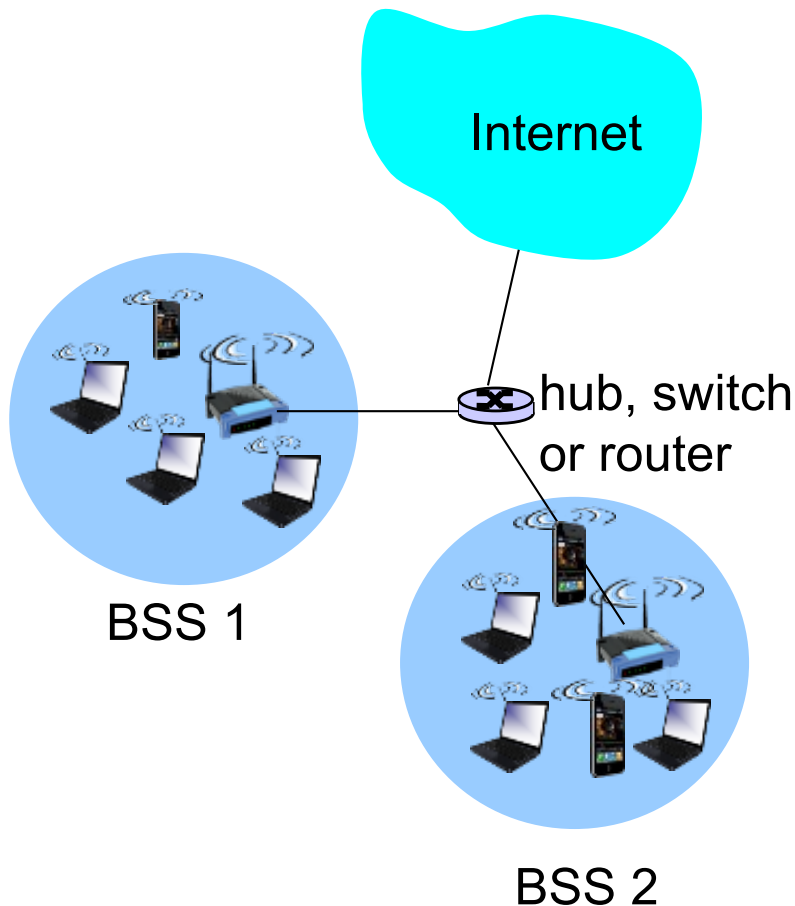


IEEE 802.11 Wireless LAN

IEEE 802.11 standard	Year	Max data rate	Range	Frequency
802.11b	1999	11 Mbps	30 m	2.4 Ghz
802.11g	2003	54 Mbps	30m	2.4 Ghz
802.11n (WiFi 4)	2009	600	70m	2.4, 5 Ghz
802.11ac (WiFi 5)	2013	3.47Gpbs	70m	5 Ghz
802.11ax (WiFi 6)	2020 (exp.)	14 Gbps	70m	2.4, 5 Ghz
802.11af	2014	35 – 560 Mbps	1 Km	unused TV bands (54-790 MHz)
802.11ah	2017	347Mbps	1 Km	900 Mhz

- all use CSMA/CA for multiple access, and have base-station and ad-hoc network versions

802.11 LAN architecture

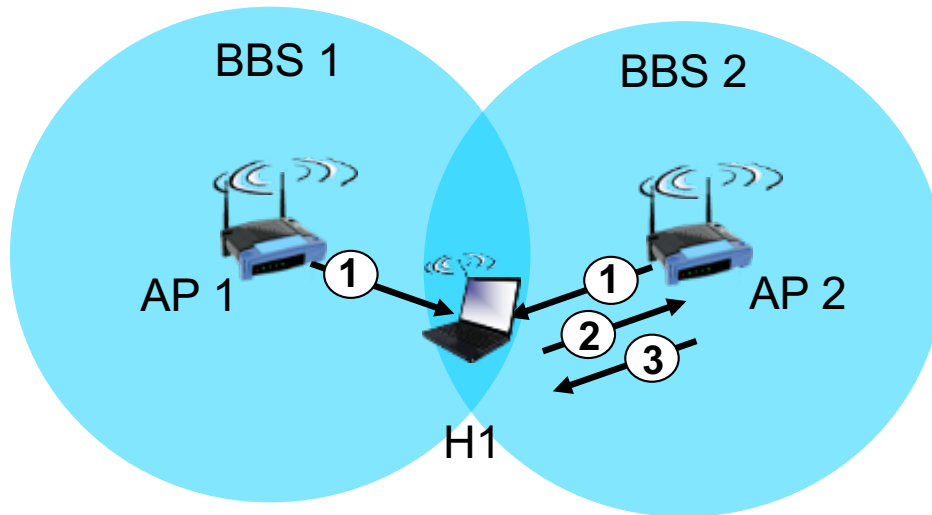


- wireless host communicates with base station
 - base station = access point (AP)
- **Basic Service Set (BSS)** (aka “cell”) in infrastructure mode contains:
 - wireless hosts
 - access point (AP): base station
 - ad hoc mode: hosts only

802.11: Channels, association

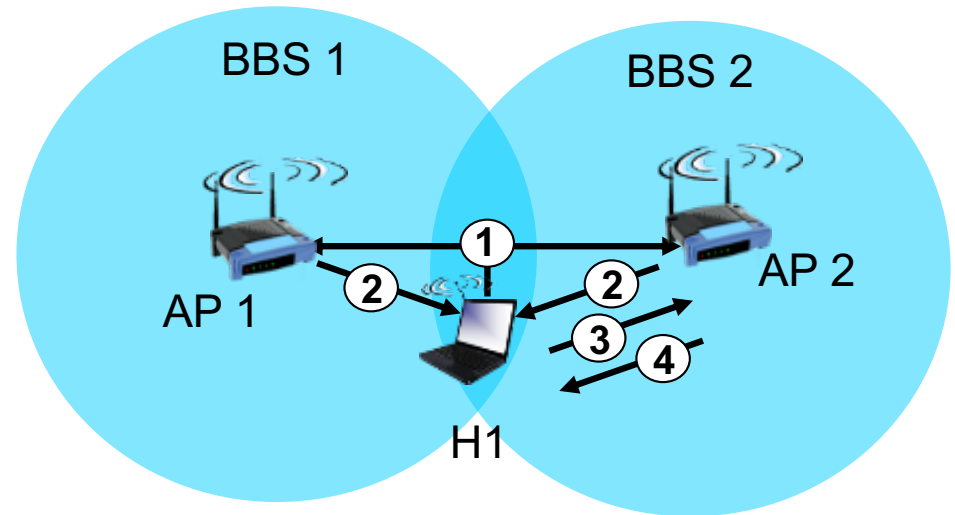
- 802.11b: 2.4GHz-2.485GHz spectrum divided into 11 channels at different frequencies
 - AP admin chooses frequency for AP
 - interference possible: channel can be same as that chosen by neighboring AP!
- host: must *associate* with an AP
 - scans channels, listening for *beacon frames* containing AP's name (SSID) and MAC address
 - selects AP to associate with
 - may perform authentication [Chapter 8]
 - will typically run DHCP to get IP address in AP's subnet

802.11: passive/active scanning



passive scanning:

- (1) beacon frames sent from APs
- (2) association Request frame sent: H1 to selected AP
- (3) association Response frame sent from selected AP to H1

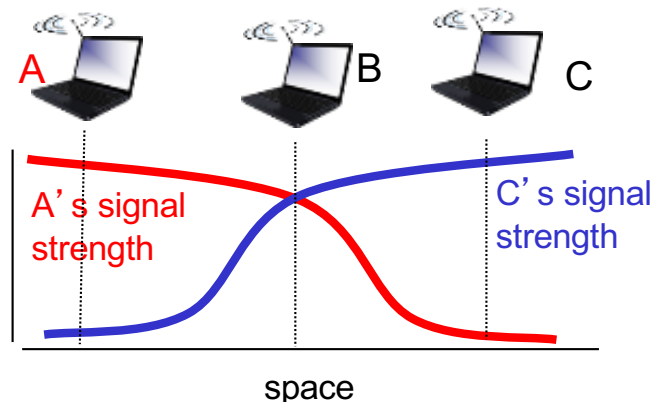
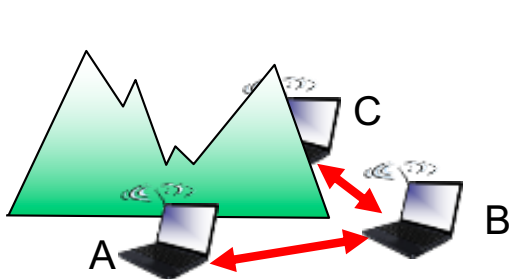


active scanning:

- (1) Probe Request frame broadcast from H1
- (2) Probe Response frames sent from APs
- (3) Association Request frame sent: H1 to selected AP
- (4) Association Response frame sent from selected AP to H1

IEEE 802.11: multiple access

- avoid collisions: 2⁺ nodes transmitting at same time
- 802.11: CSMA - sense before transmitting
 - don't collide with ongoing transmission by other node
- 802.11: *no* collision detection!
 - difficult to receive (sense collisions) when transmitting due to weak received signals (fading)
 - can't sense all collisions in any case: hidden terminal, fading
 - goal: *avoid collisions*: CSMA/C(ollision)A(voidance)



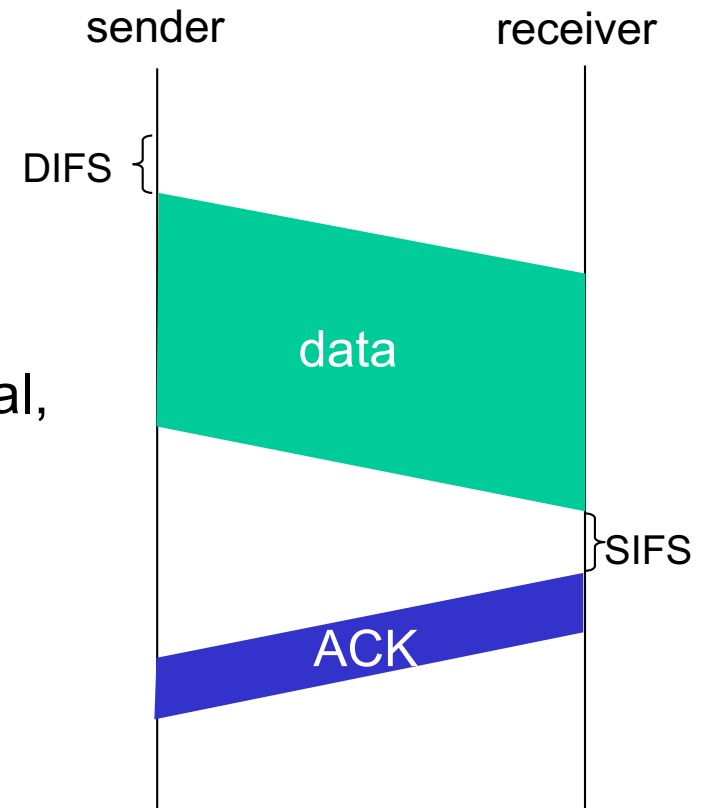
IEEE 802.11 MAC Protocol: CSMA/CA

802.11 sender

- 1 if sense channel idle for **DIFS** then
transmit entire frame (no CD)
- 2 if sense channel busy then
start random backoff time
timer counts down while channel idle
transmit when timer expires
if no ACK, increase random backoff interval,
repeat 2

802.11 receiver

- if frame received OK
return ACK after **SIFS** (ACK needed due to
hidden terminal problem)



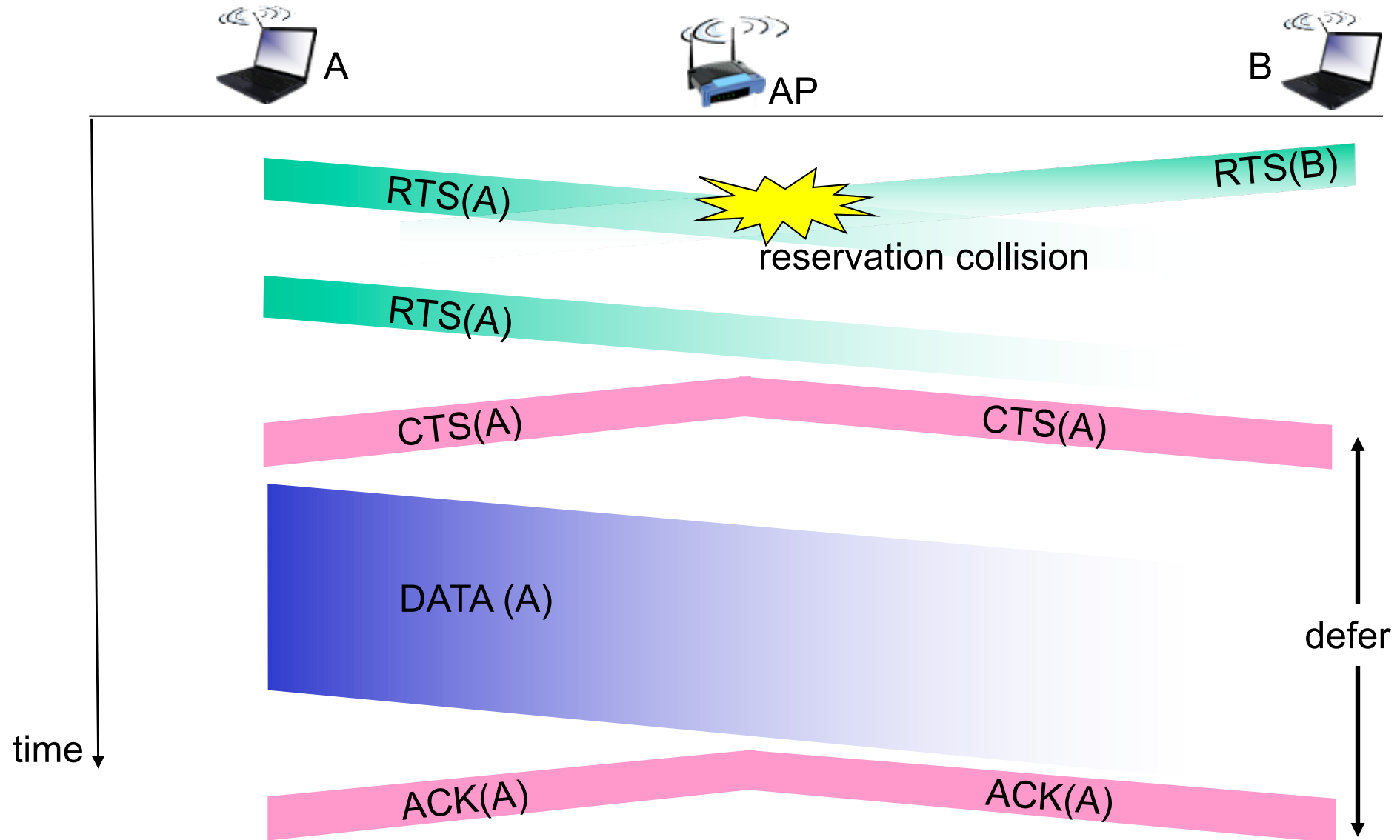
Avoiding collisions (more)

idea: allow sender to “reserve” channel rather than random access of data frames: avoid collisions of long data frames

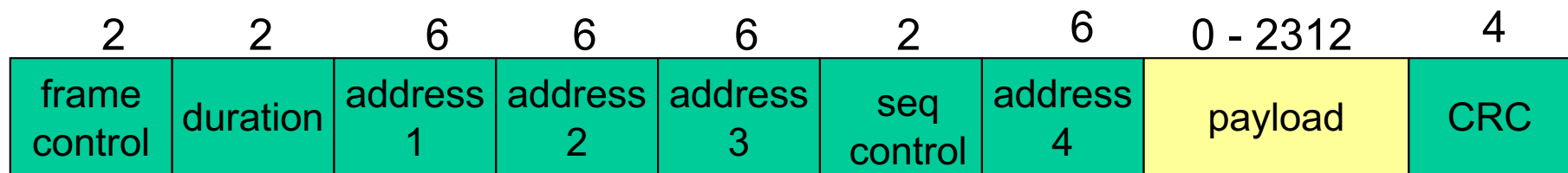
- sender first transmits *small* request-to-send (RTS) packets to BS using CSMA
 - RTSs may still collide with each other (but they’re short)
- BS broadcasts clear-to-send CTS in response to RTS
- CTS heard by all nodes
 - sender transmits data frame
 - other stations defer transmissions

*avoid data frame collisions completely
using small reservation packets!*

Collision Avoidance: RTS-CTS exchange



802.11 frame: addressing



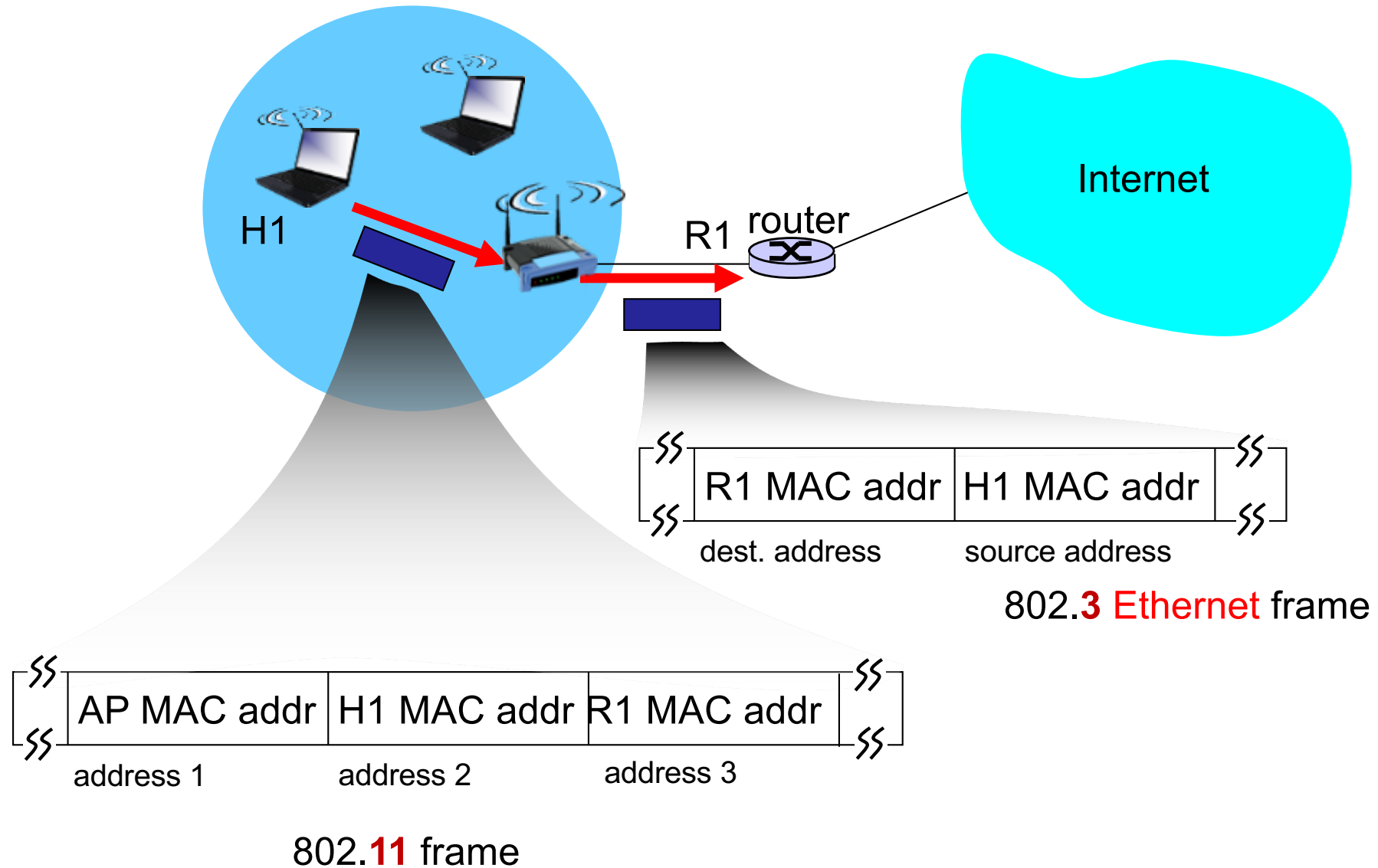
Address 1: MAC address of wireless host or AP to receive this frame

Address 2: MAC address of wireless host or AP transmitting this frame

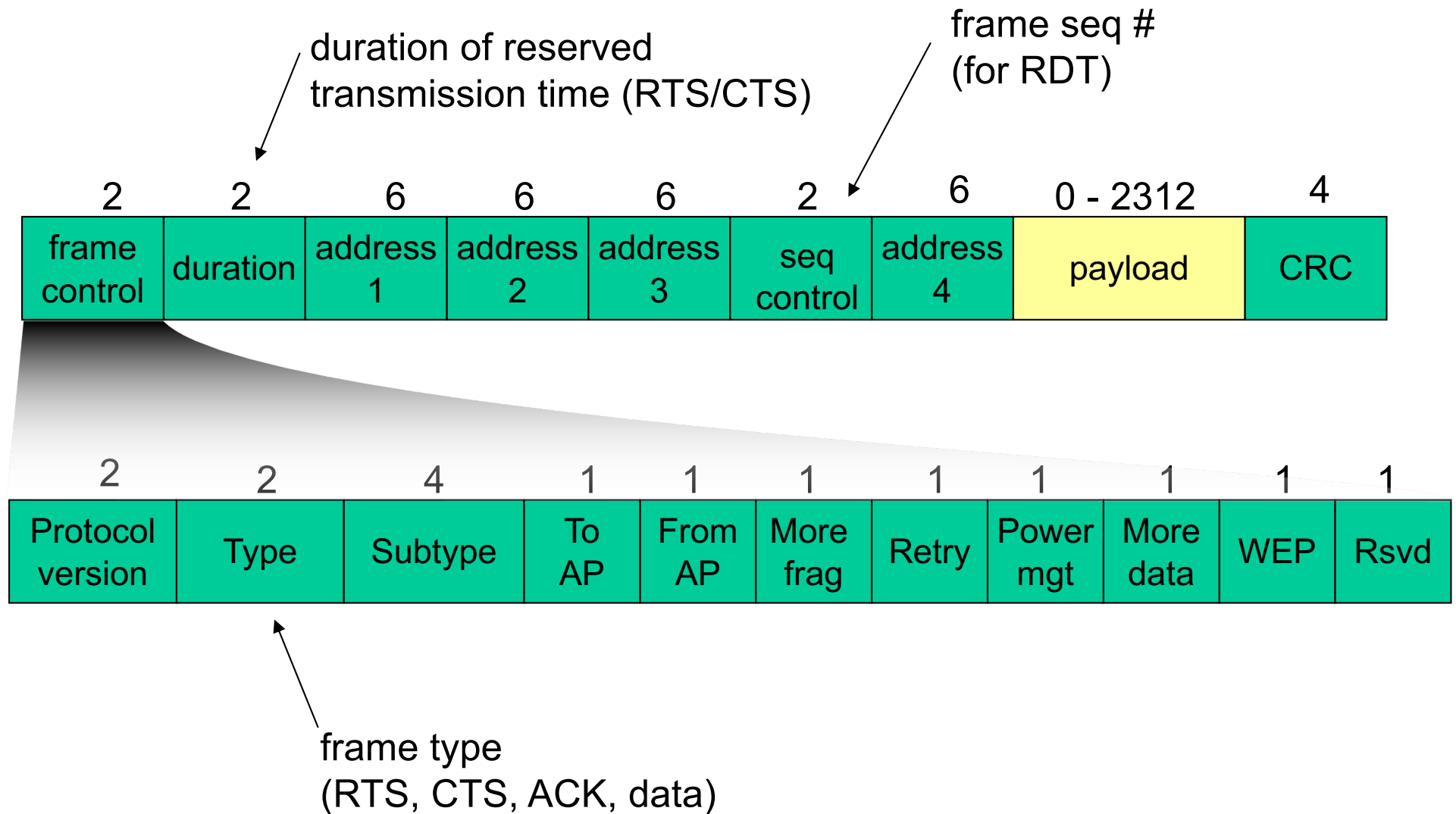
Address 3: MAC address of router interface to which AP is attached

Address 4: used only in ad hoc mode

802.11 frame: addressing

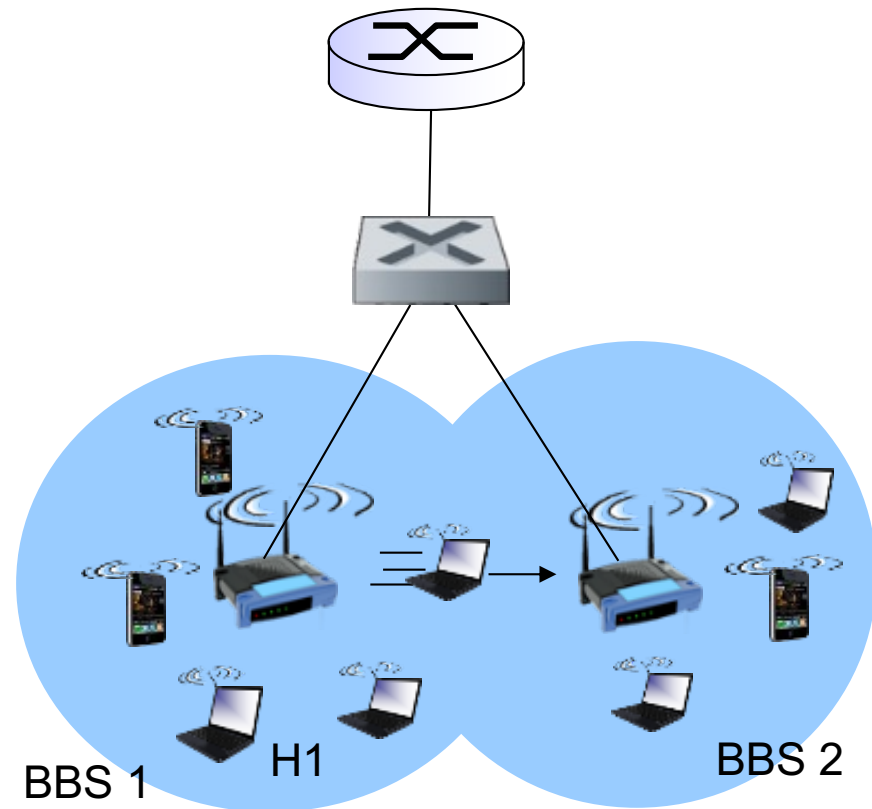


802.11 frame: more



802.11: mobility within same subnet

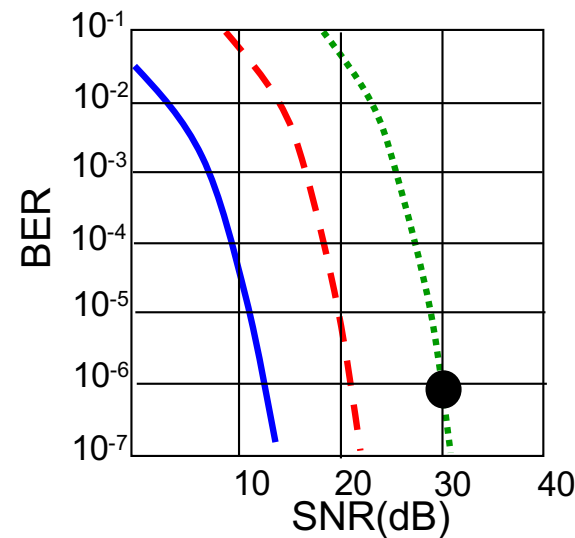
- HI remains in same IP subnet: IP address can remain same
- switch: which AP is associated with HI?
 - self-learning (Ch. 5): switch will see frame from HI and “remember” which switch port can be used to reach HI



802.11: advanced capabilities

Rate adaptation

- base station, mobile dynamically change transmission rate (physical layer modulation technique) as mobile moves, SNR varies



- QAM256 (8 Mbps)
- - - QAM16 (4 Mbps)
- BPSK (1 Mbps)
- operating point

- SNR decreases, BER increase as node moves away from base station
- When BER becomes too high, switch to lower transmission rate but with lower BER

802.11: advanced capabilities

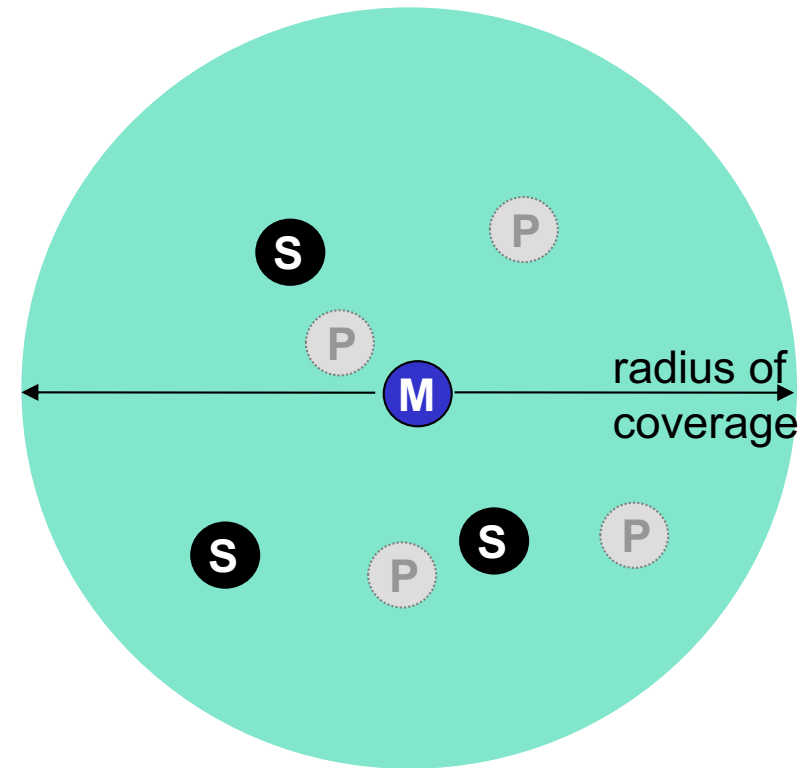
power management

- node-to-AP: “I am going to sleep until next beacon frame”
 - AP knows not to transmit frames to this node
 - node wakes up before next beacon frame
- beacon frame: contains list of mobiles with AP-to-mobile frames waiting to be sent
 - node will stay awake if AP-to-mobile frames to be sent; otherwise sleep again until next beacon frame



802.15: personal area network (Bluetooth)

- less than 10 m diameter
- replacement for cables (mouse, keyboard, headphones)
- ad hoc: no infrastructure
- master/slaves:
 - slaves request permission to send (to master)
 - master grants requests
- 802.15: evolved from Bluetooth specification
 - 2.4-2.5 GHz radio band
 - up to 3 Mbps



- M** Master device
- S** Slave device
- P** Parked device (inactive)

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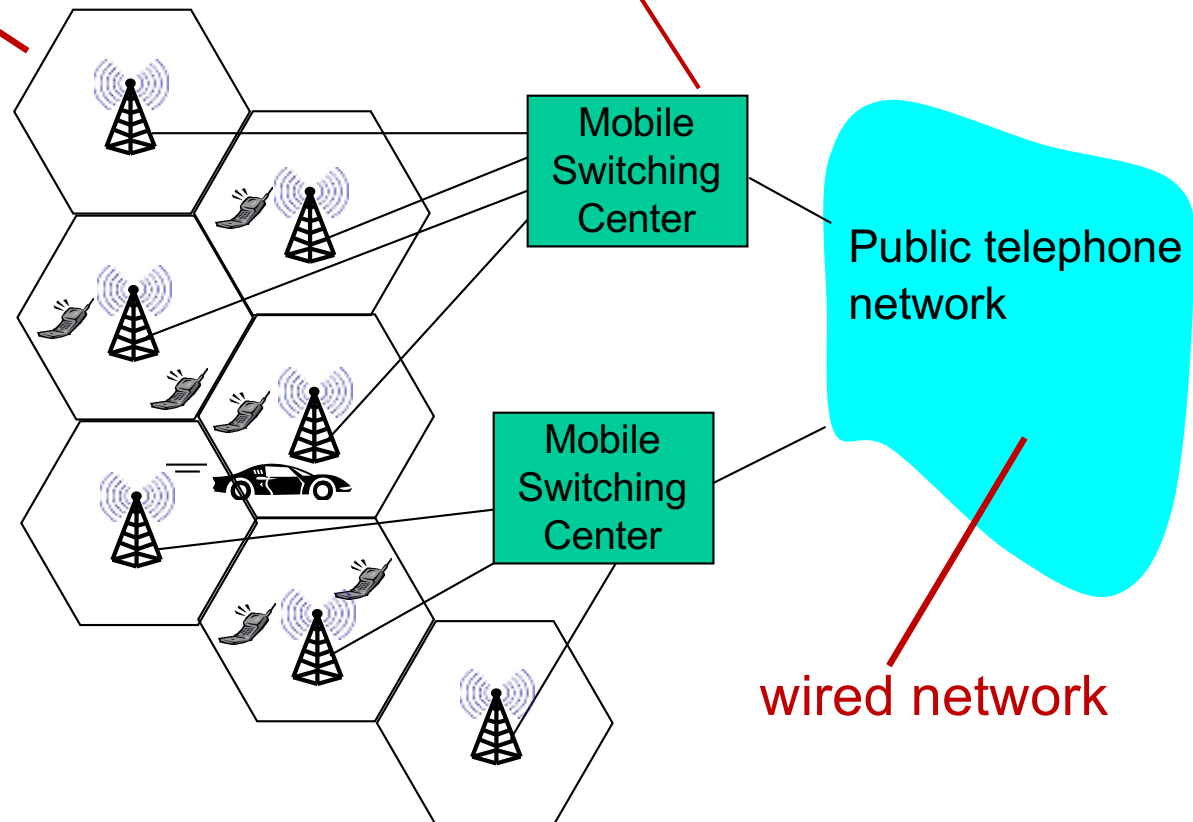
Components of cellular network architecture

cell

- ❖ covers geographical region
- ❖ *base station* (BS) analogous to 802.11 AP
- ❖ *mobile users* attach to network through BS
- ❖ *air-interface*: physical and link layer protocol between mobile and BS

MSC

- ❖ connects cells to wired tel. net.
- ❖ manages call setup (more later!)
- ❖ handles mobility (more later!)

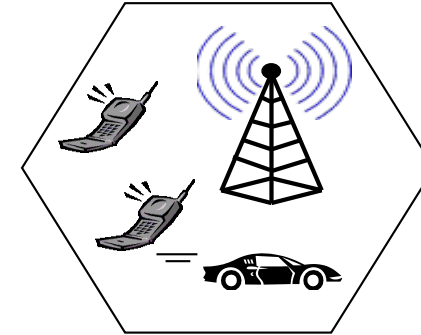


wired network

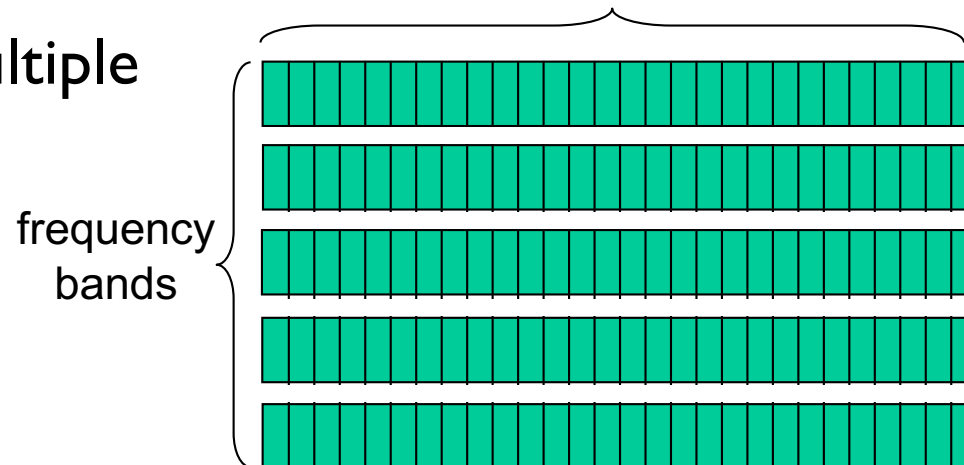
Cellular networks: the first hop

Two techniques for sharing mobile-to-BS radio spectrum

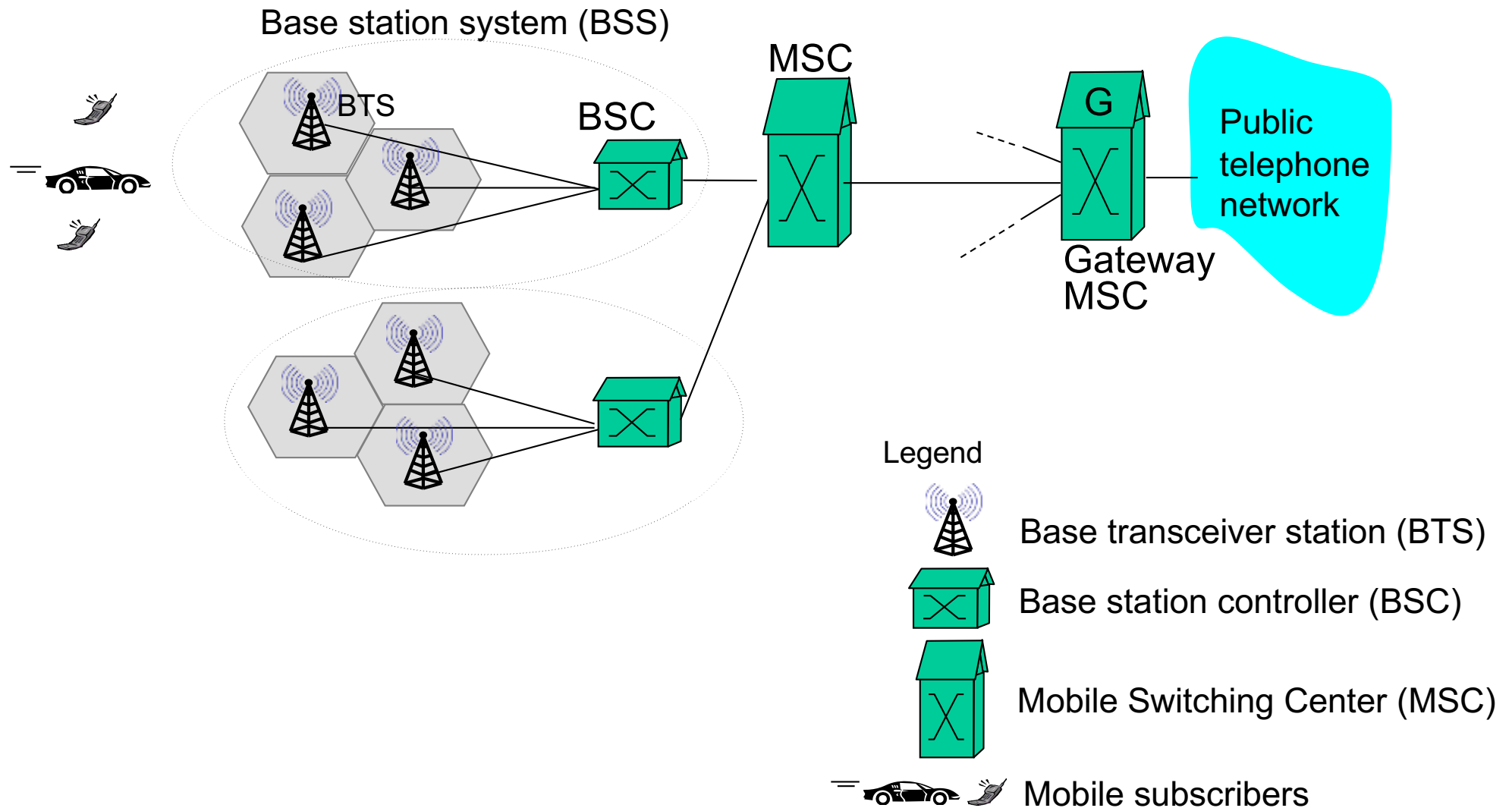
- **combined FDMA/TDMA:** divide spectrum in frequency channels, divide each channel into time slots
- **CDMA:** code division multiple access



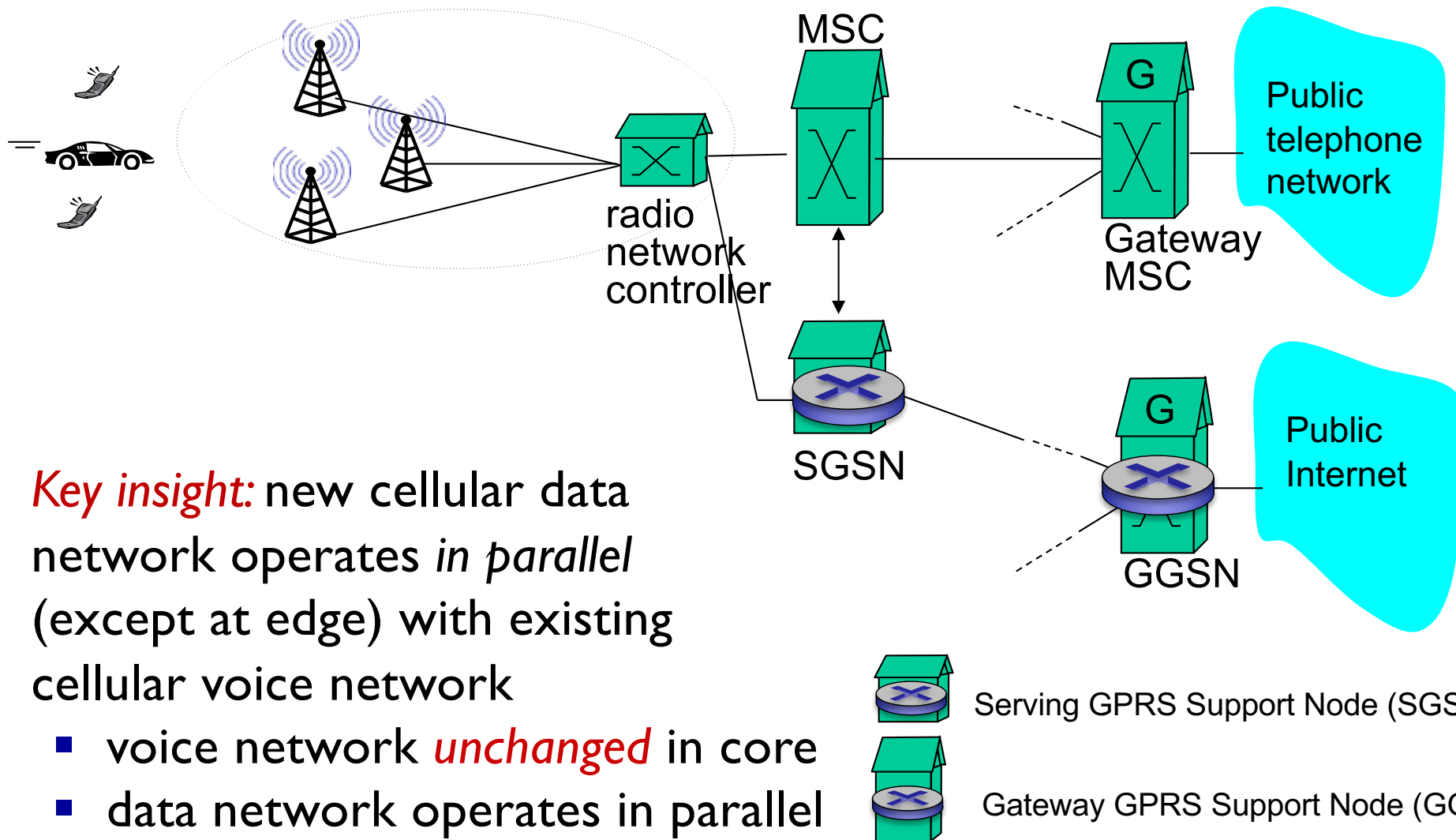
time slots



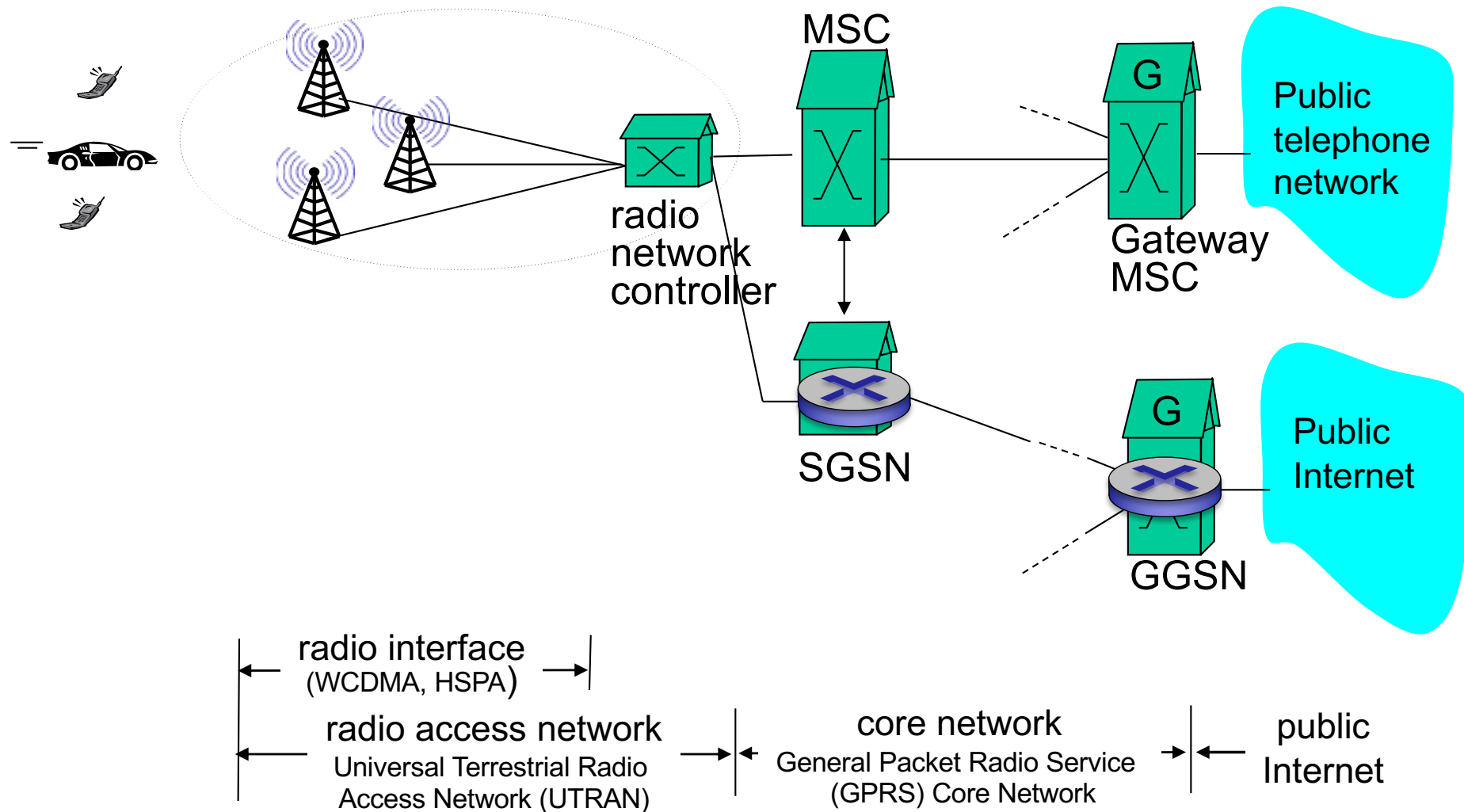
2G (voice) network architecture



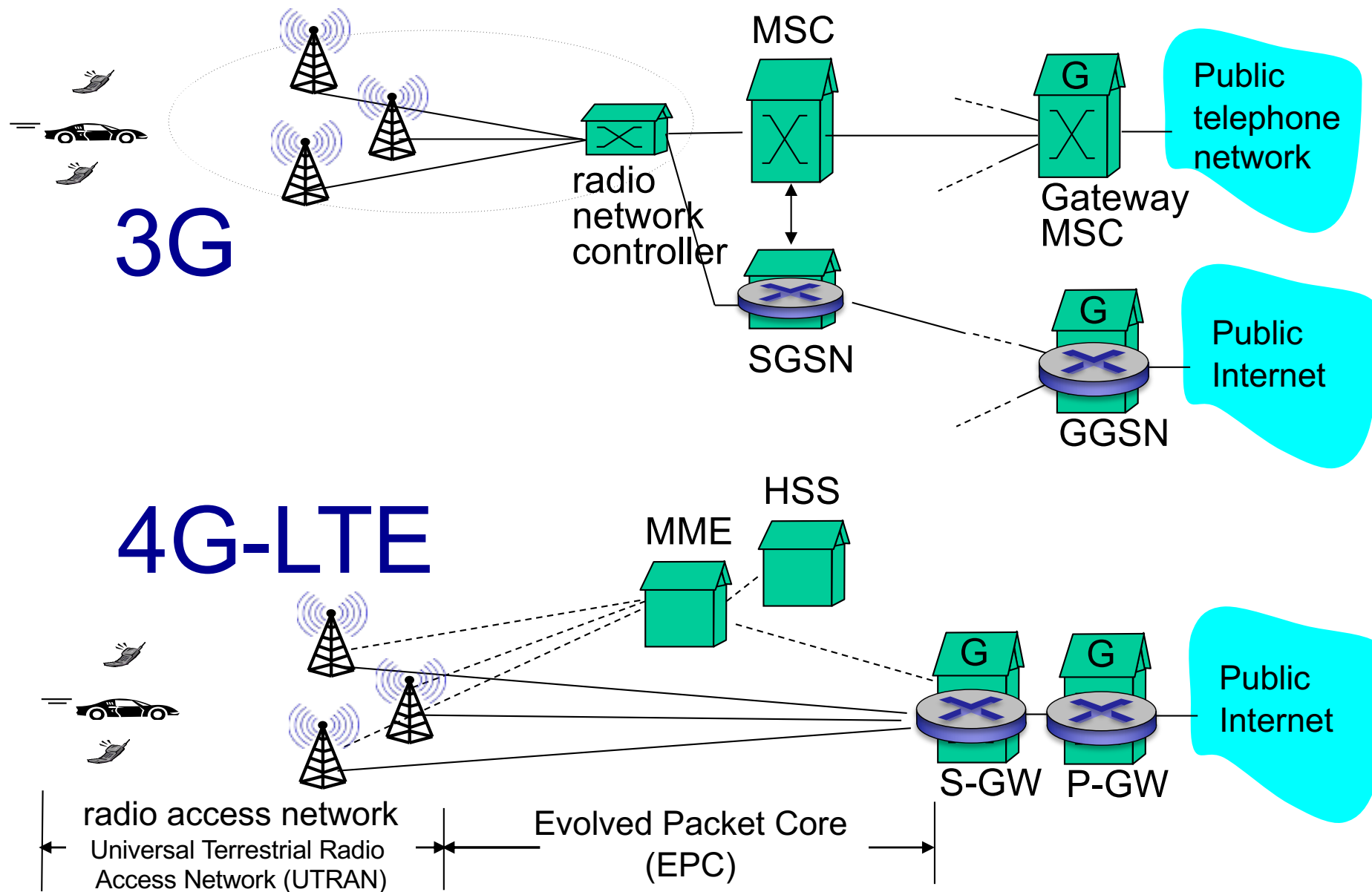
3G (voice+data) network architecture



3G (voice+data) network architecture

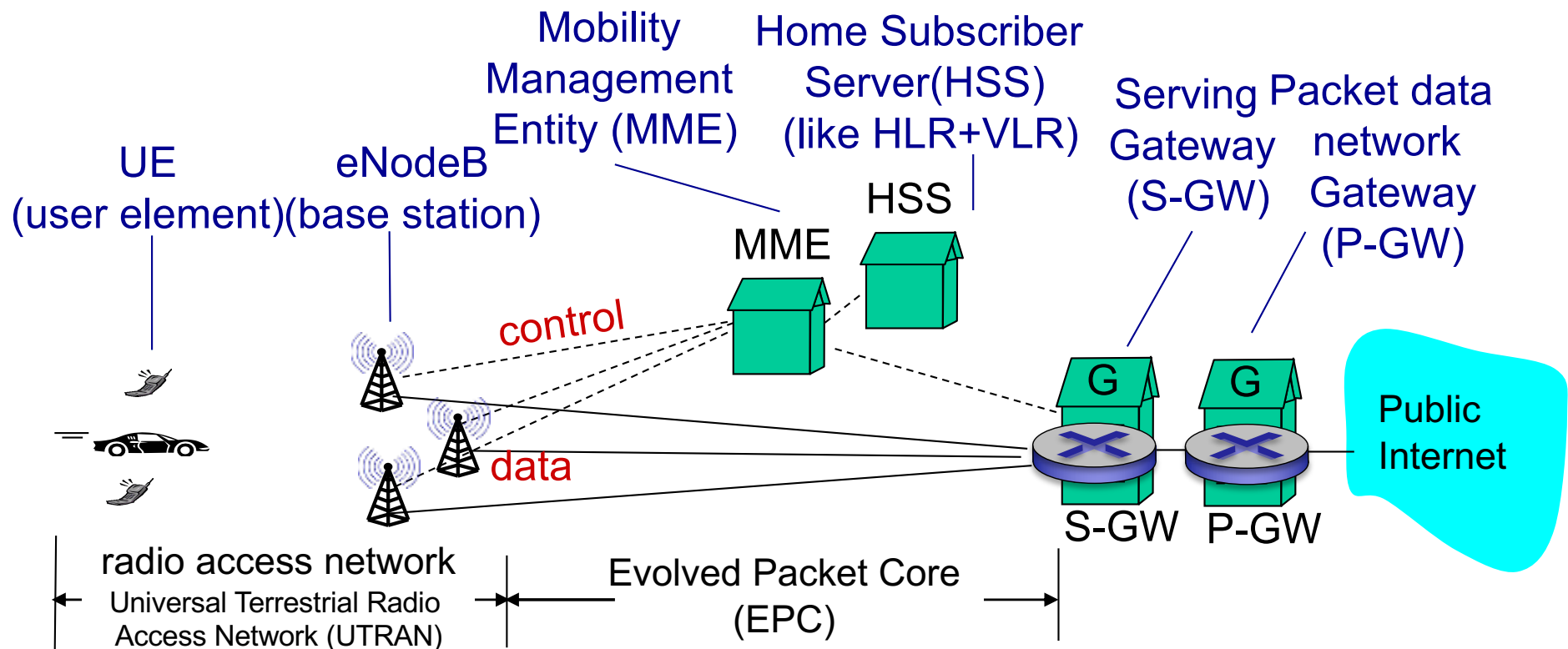


3G versus 4G LTE network architecture



4G: differences from 3G

- all IP core: IP packets tunneled (through core IP network) from base station to gateway
- no separation between voice and data – all traffic carried over IP core to gateway



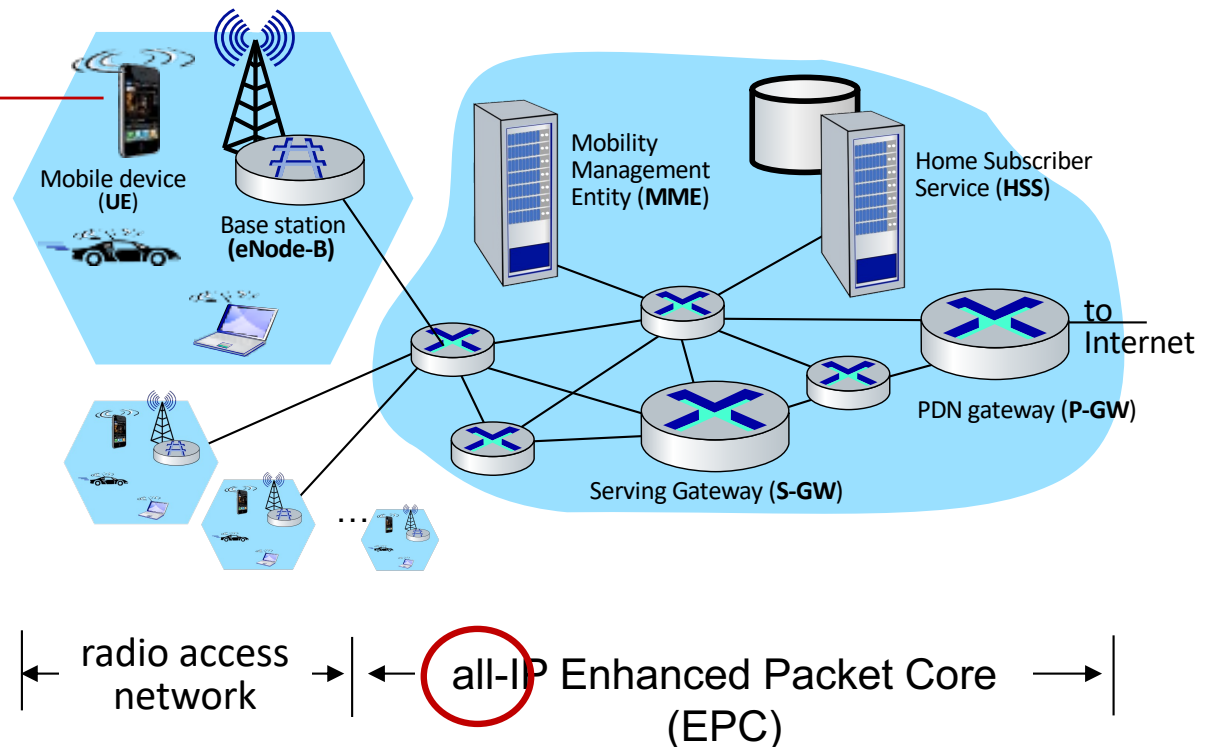
Elements of 4G LTE architecture



Extra Slide

Mobile device:

- smartphone, tablet, laptop, IoT, ... with 4G LTE radio
- 64-bit International Mobile Subscriber Identity (IMSI), stored on SIM (Subscriber Identity Module) card
- LTE jargon: User Equipment (UE)

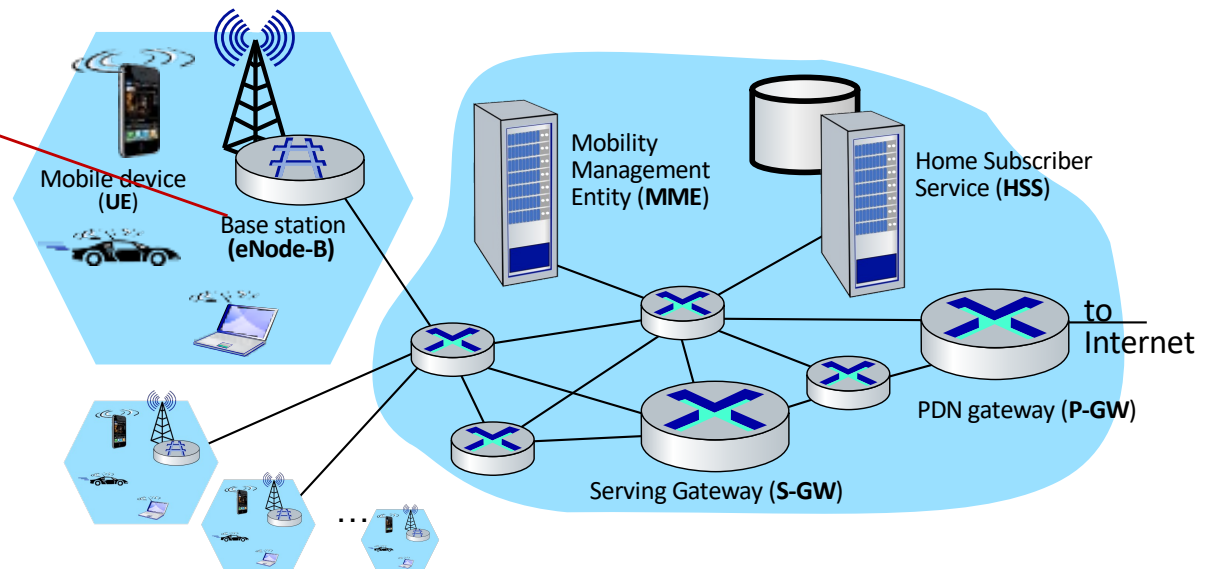




Elements of 4G LTE architecture

Base station:

- at “edge” of carrier’s network
- manages wireless radio resources, mobile devices in its coverage area (“cell”)
- coordinates device authentication with other elements
- similar to WiFi AP but:
 - active role in user mobility
 - coordinates with nearly base stations to optimize radio use
- LTE jargon: eNode-B



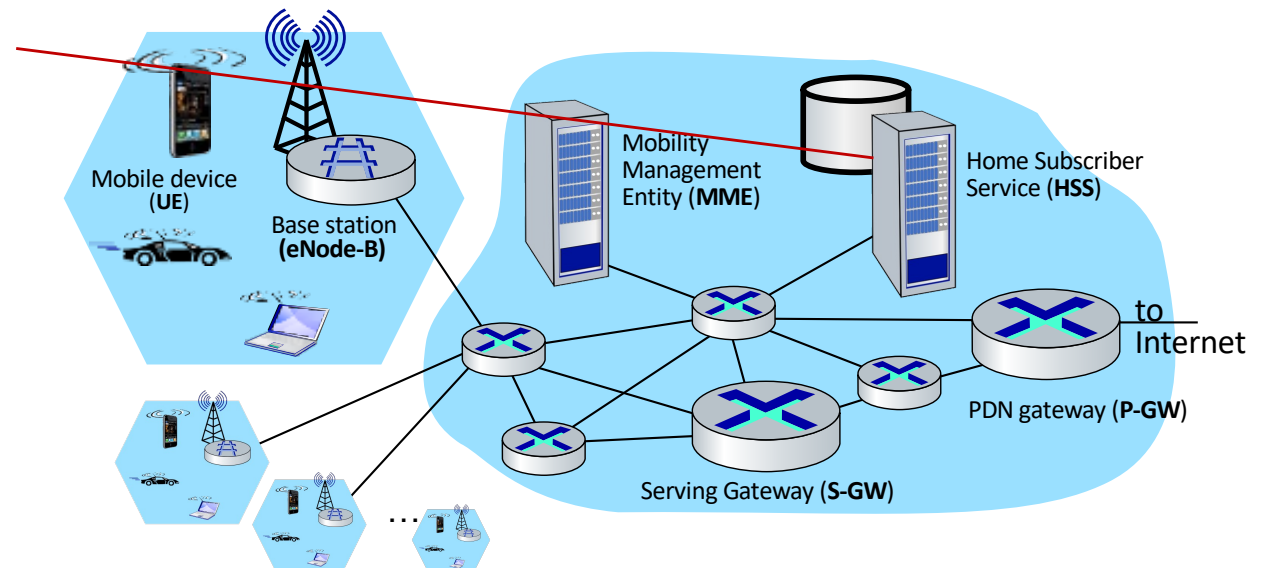


Elements of 4G LTE architecture

Extra Slide

Home Subscriber Service

- stores info about mobile devices for which the HSS's network is their "home network"
- works with MME in device authentication



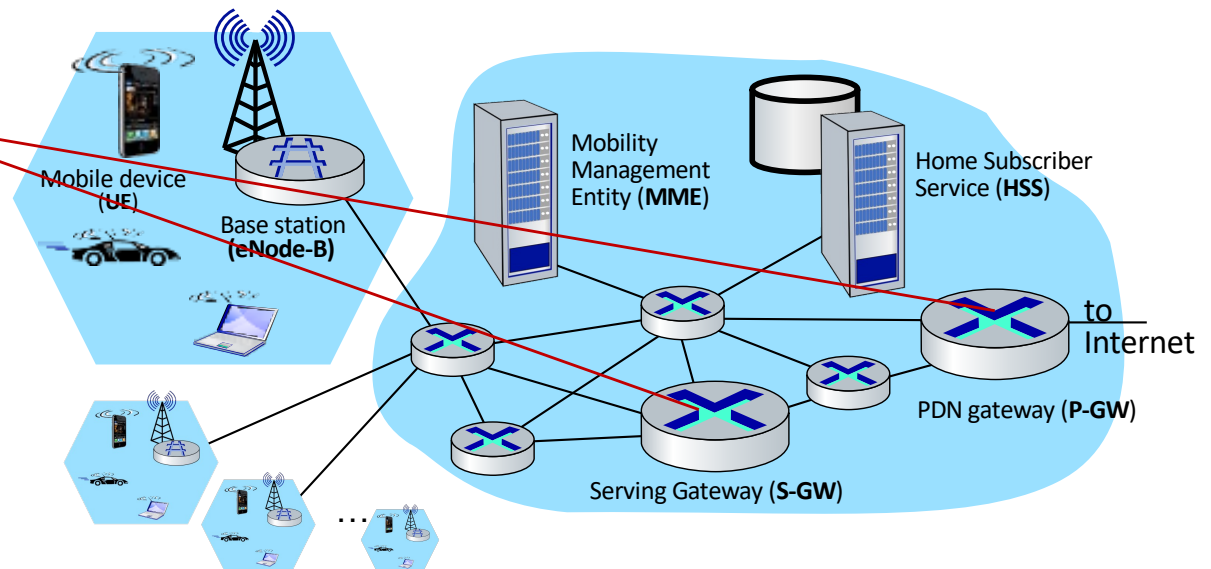
Elements of 4G LTE architecture



Extra Slide

Serving Gateway (S-GW), PDN Gateway (P-GW)

- lie on data path from mobile to/from Internet
- P-GW
 - gateway to mobile cellular network
 - Looks like any other internet gateway router
 - provides NAT services
- other routers:
 - extensive use of tunneling



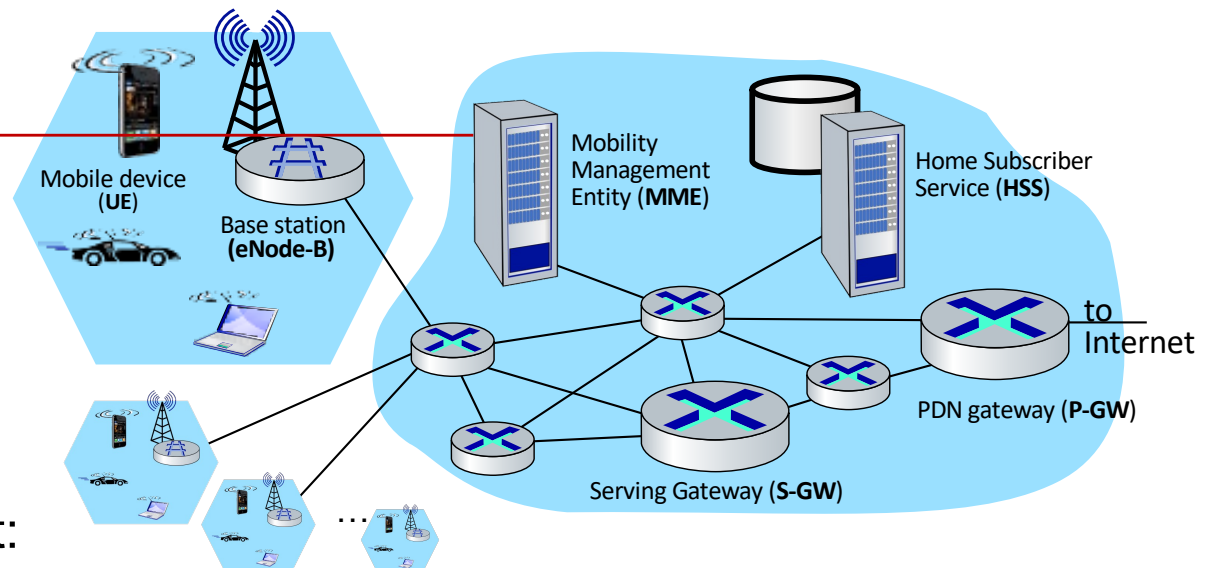
Elements of 4G LTE architecture



Extra Slide

Mobility Management Entity

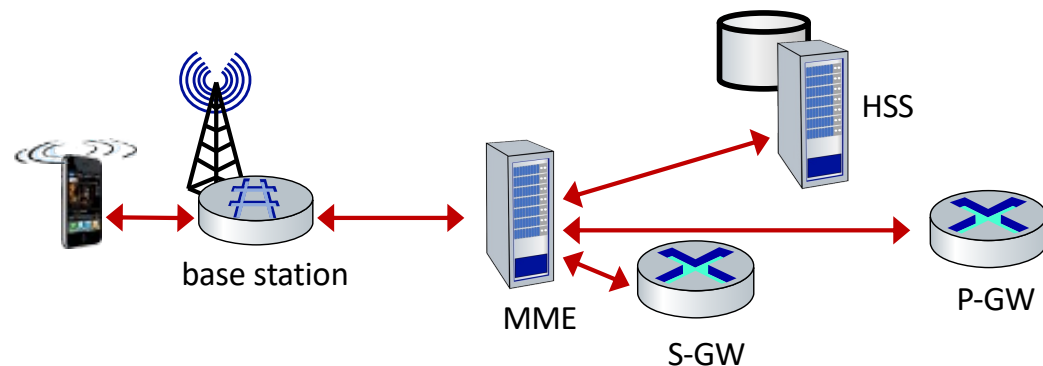
- device authentication (device-to-network, network-to-device) coordinated with mobile home network HSS
- mobile device management:
 - device handover between cells
 - tracking/paging device location
- path (tunneling) setup from mobile device to P-GW



LTE: data plane control plane separation

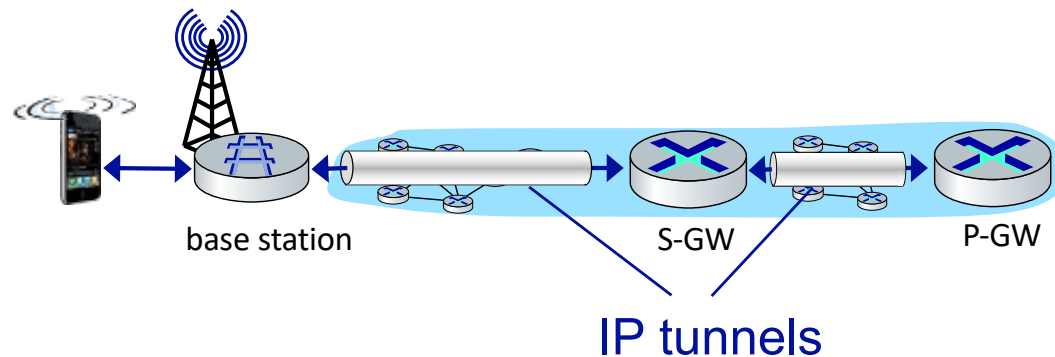


Extra Slide



control plane

- new protocols for mobility management, security, authentication (later)



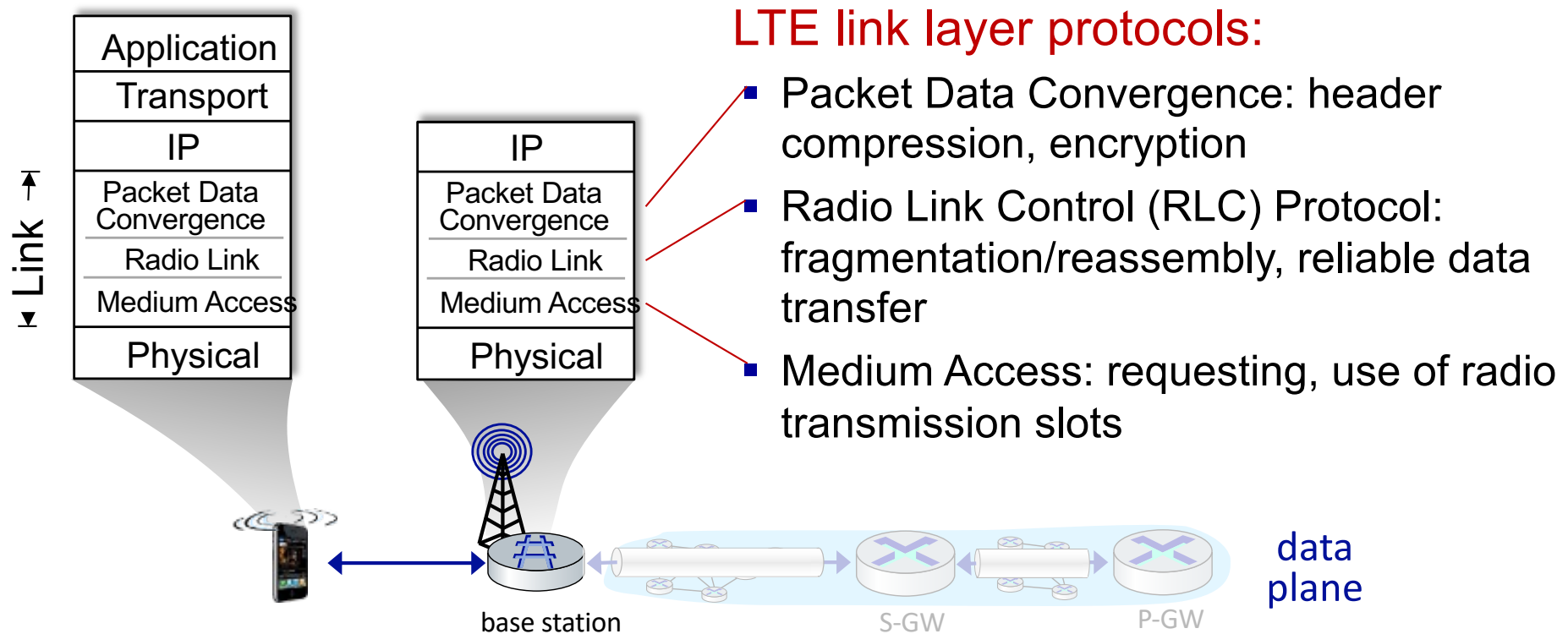
data plane

- new protocols at link, physical layers
- extensive use of tunneling to facilitate mobility

LTE data plane protocol stack: first hop



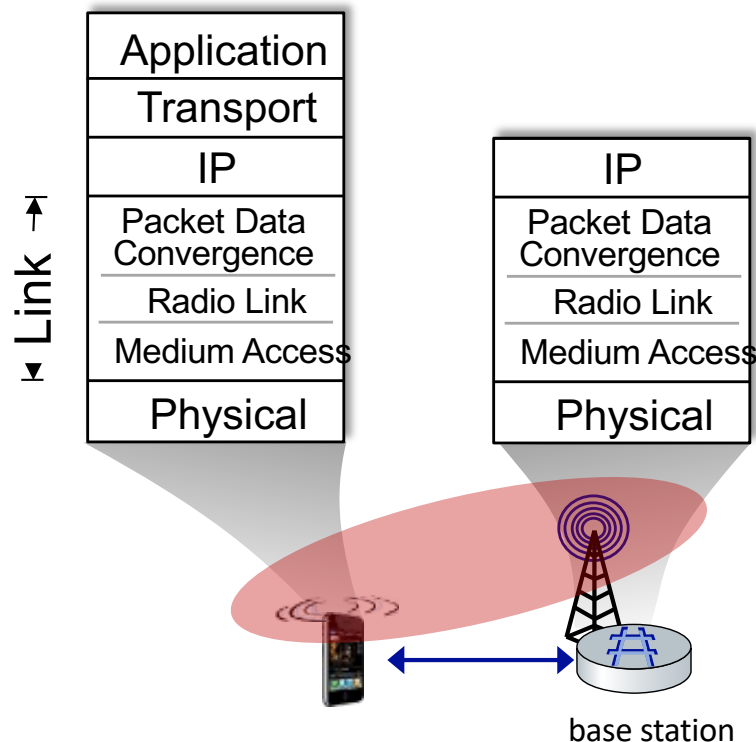
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LTE data plane protocol stack: first hop



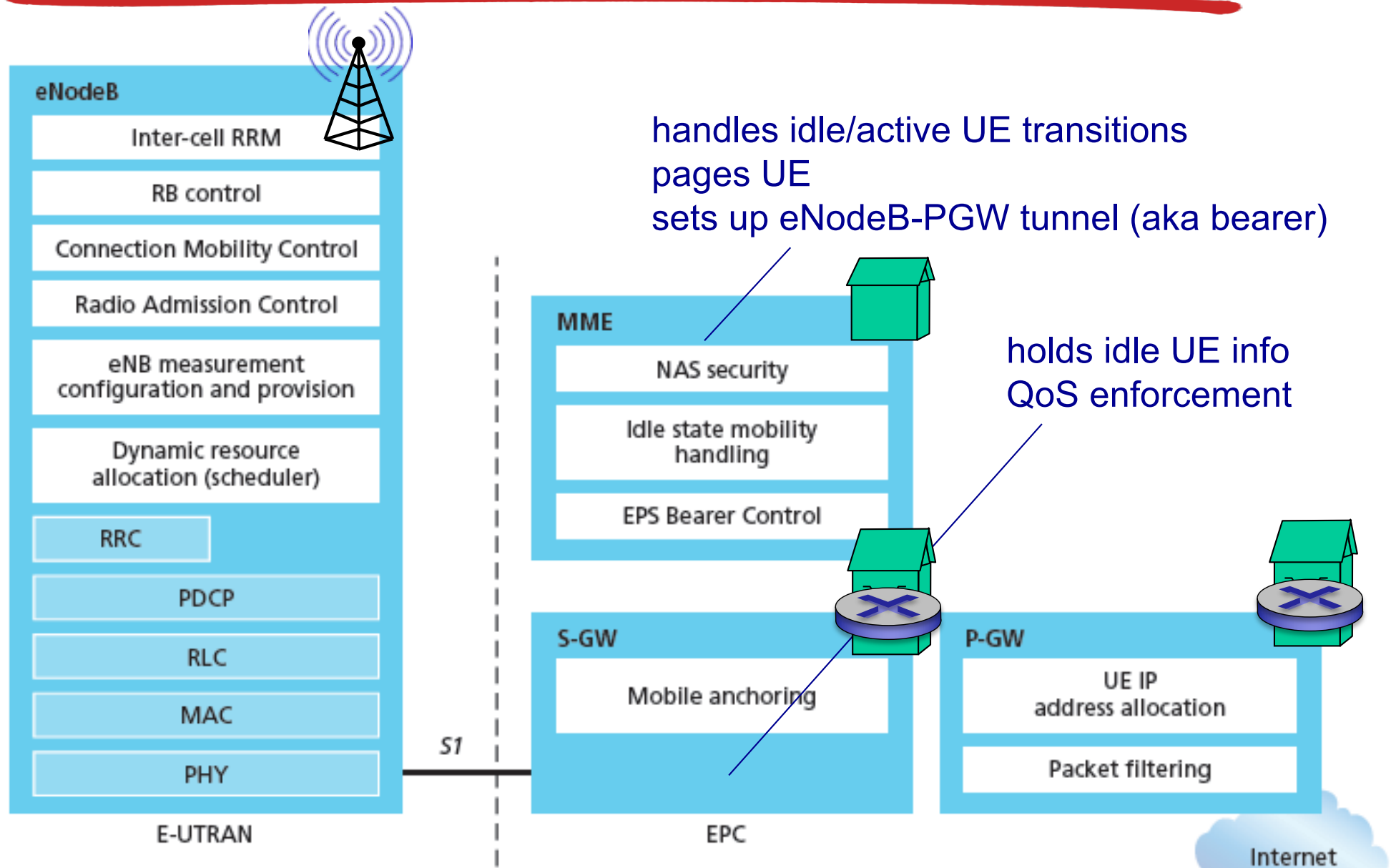
Extra Slide



LTE radio access network:

- **downstream channel:** FDM, TDM within frequency channel (OFDM - orthogonal frequency division multiplexing)
 - “orthogonal”: minimal interference between channels
 - **upstream:** FDM, TDM similar to OFDM
- each active mobile device allocated two or more 0.5 ms time slots over 12 frequencies
 - scheduling algorithm not standardized – up to operator
 - 100's Mbps per device possible

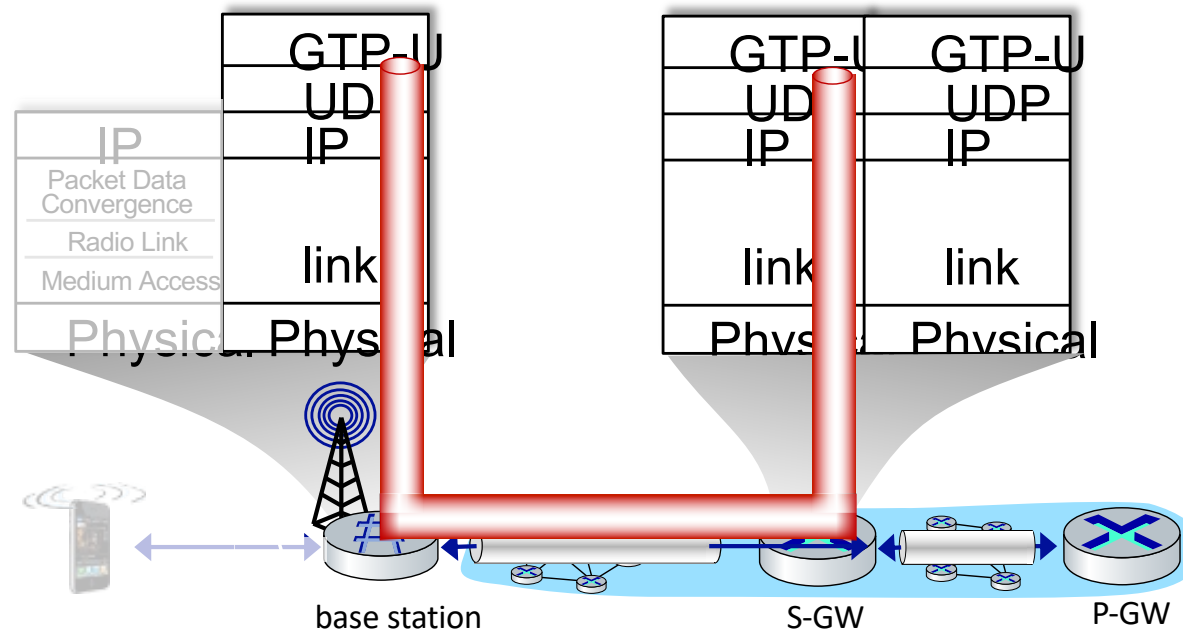
Functional split of major LTE components





Extra Slide

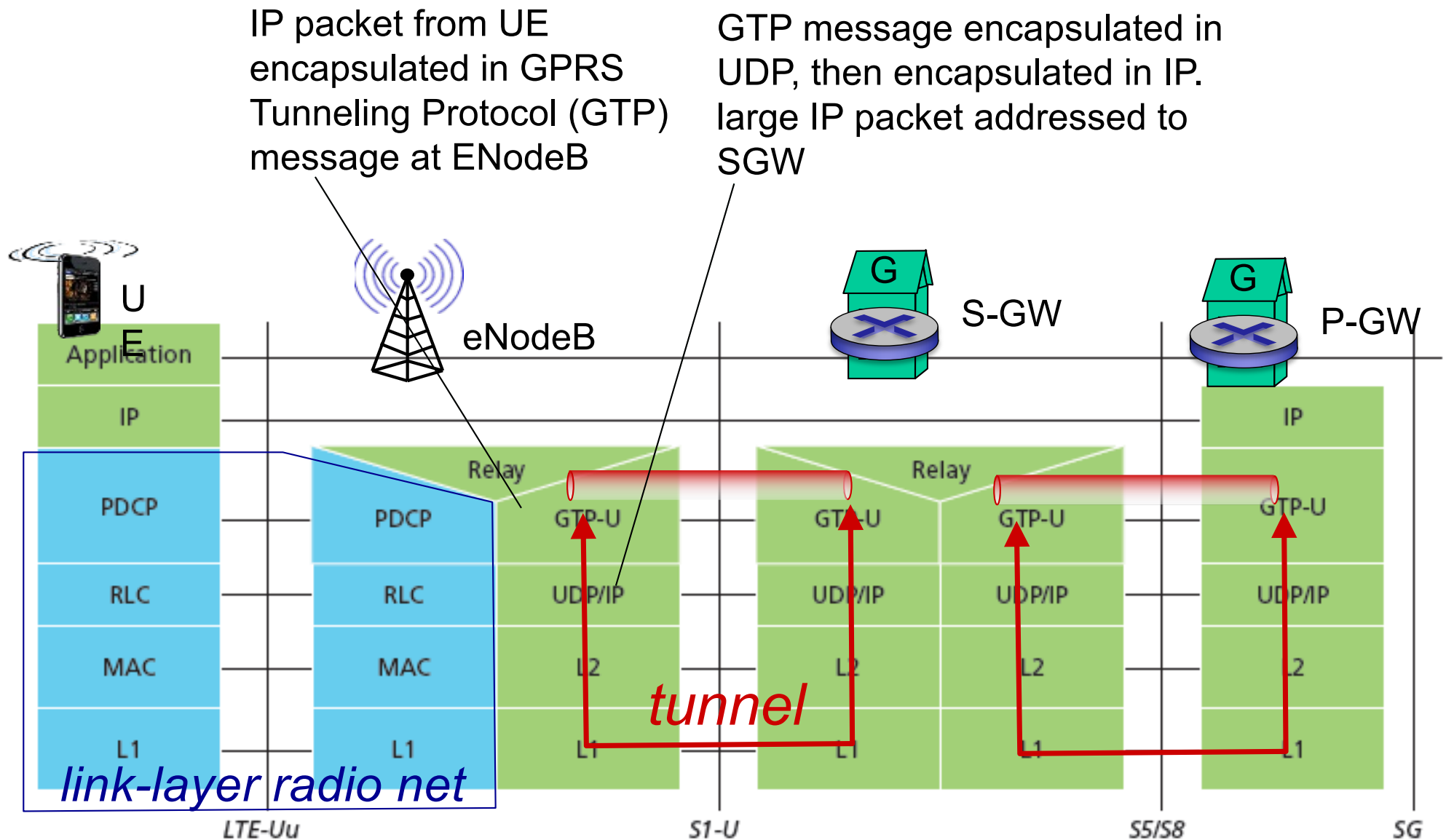
LTE data plane protocol stack: packet core



tunneling:

- mobile datagram encapsulated using GPRS Tunneling Protocol (GTP), sent inside UDP datagram to S-GW
- S-GW re-tunnels datagrams to P-GW
- supporting mobility: only tunneling endpoints change when mobile user moves

Radio+Tunneling: UE – eNodeB – PGW



Quality of Service in LTE

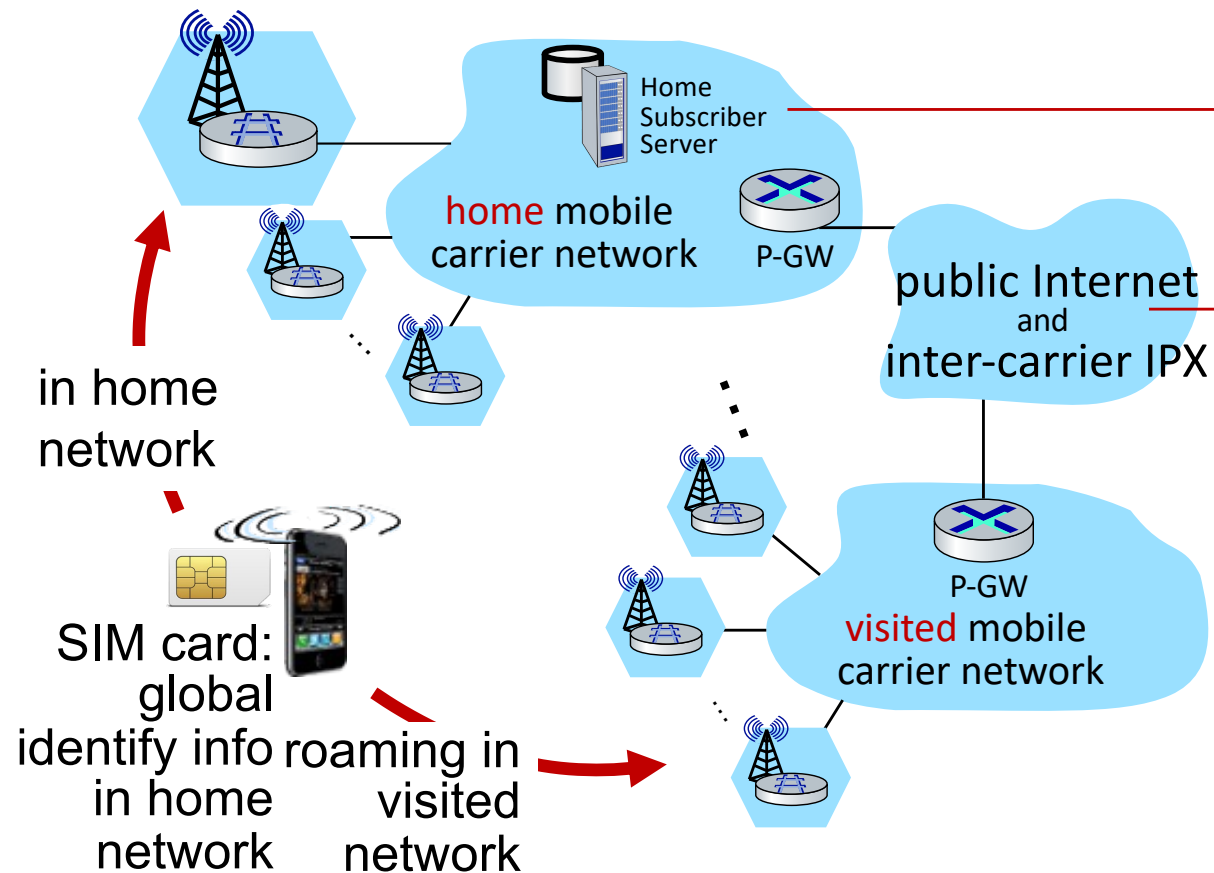
- QoS from eNodeB to SGW: min and max guaranteed bit rate
- QoS in radio access network: one of 12 QCI values

QCI	RESOURCE TYPE	PRIORITY	PACKET DELAY BUDGET (MS)	PACKET ERROR LOSS RATE	EXAMPLE SERVICES
1	GBR	2	100	10^{-2}	Conversational voice
2	GBR	4	150	10^{-3}	Conversational video (live streaming)
3	GBR	5	300	10^{-6}	Non-conversational video (buffered streaming)
4	GBR	3	50	10^{-3}	Real-time gaming
5	Non-GBR	1	100	10^{-6}	IMS signaling
6	Non-GBR	7	100	10^{-3}	Voice, video (live streaming), interactive gaming
7	Non-GBR	6	300	10^{-6}	Video (buffered streaming)
8	Non-GBR	8	300	10^{-6}	TCP-based (for example, WWW, e-mail), chat, FTP, p2p file sharing, progressive video and others
9	Non-GBR	9	300	10^{-6}	

Global cellular network: a network of IP networks



Extra Slide



home network HSS:

- identify & services info, while in home network and roaming

all IP:

- carriers interconnect with each other, and public internet at exchange points
- legacy 2G, 3G: not all IP, handled otherwise



On to 5G!

- **goal:** 10x increase in peak bitrate, 10x decrease in latency, 100x increase in traffic capacity over 4G
- **5G NR (new radio):**
 - two frequency bands: FR1 (450 MHz–6 GHz) and FR2 (24 GHz–52 GHz): millimeter wave frequencies
 - not backwards-compatible with 4G
 - MIMO: multiple directional antennae
- **millimeter wave frequencies:** much higher data rates, but over shorter distances
 - pico-cells: cells diameters: 10-100 m
 - massive, dense deployment of new base stations required



4G/5G cellular networks

similarities to wired Internet

- edge/core distinction, but both below to same carrier
- global cellular network: a network of networks
- widespread use of protocols we've studied: HTTP, DNS, TCP, UDP, IP, NAT, separation of data/control planes, SDN, Ethernet, tunneling
- interconnected to wired Internet

differences from wired Internet

- different wireless link layer
- mobility as a 1st class service
- user “identity” (via SIM card)
- business model: users subscribe to a cellular provider
 - strong notion of “home network” versus roaming on visited nets
 - global access, with authentication infrastructure, and inter-carrier settlements

Chapter 7 outline

7.1 Introduction

Wireless

7.2 Wireless links, characteristics

- CDMA

7.3 IEEE 802.11 wireless LANs (“Wi-Fi”)

7.4 Cellular Internet Access

- architecture
- standards (e.g., 3G, LTE, 4G and 5G)

Mobility

7.5 Principles: addressing and routing to mobile users

7.6 Mobile IP

7.7 Handling mobility in cellular networks

7.8 Mobility and higher-layer protocols

What is mobility?

- spectrum of mobility, from the **network** perspective:

no mobility high mobility



device moves
between
networks, but
powers down
while moving

device moves
within same AP
in
one provider
network

device moves
among APs in
one provider
network

device moves
among multiple
provider networks,
while maintaining
ongoing
connections

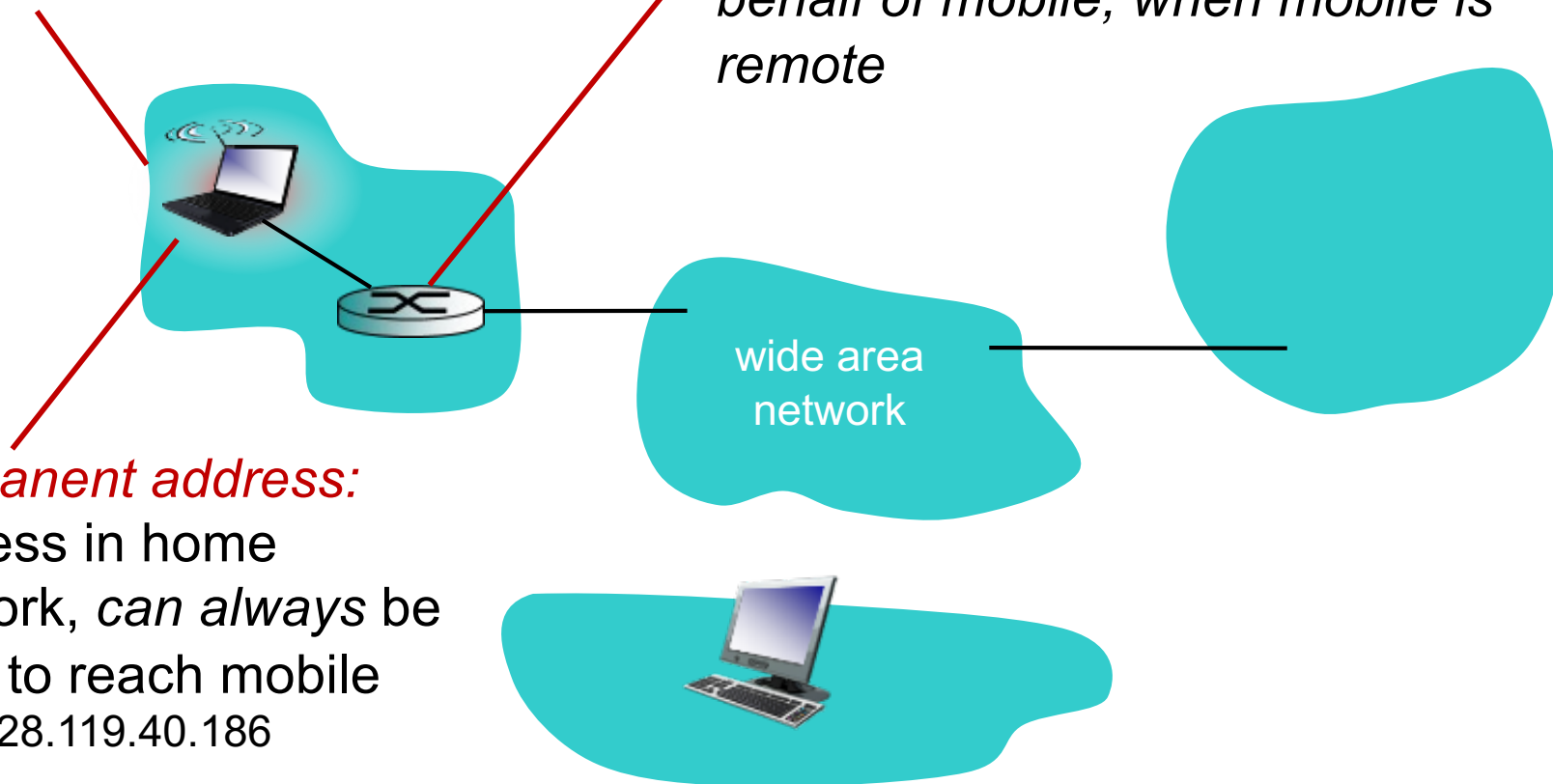
We're interested in these!

Mobility: vocabulary

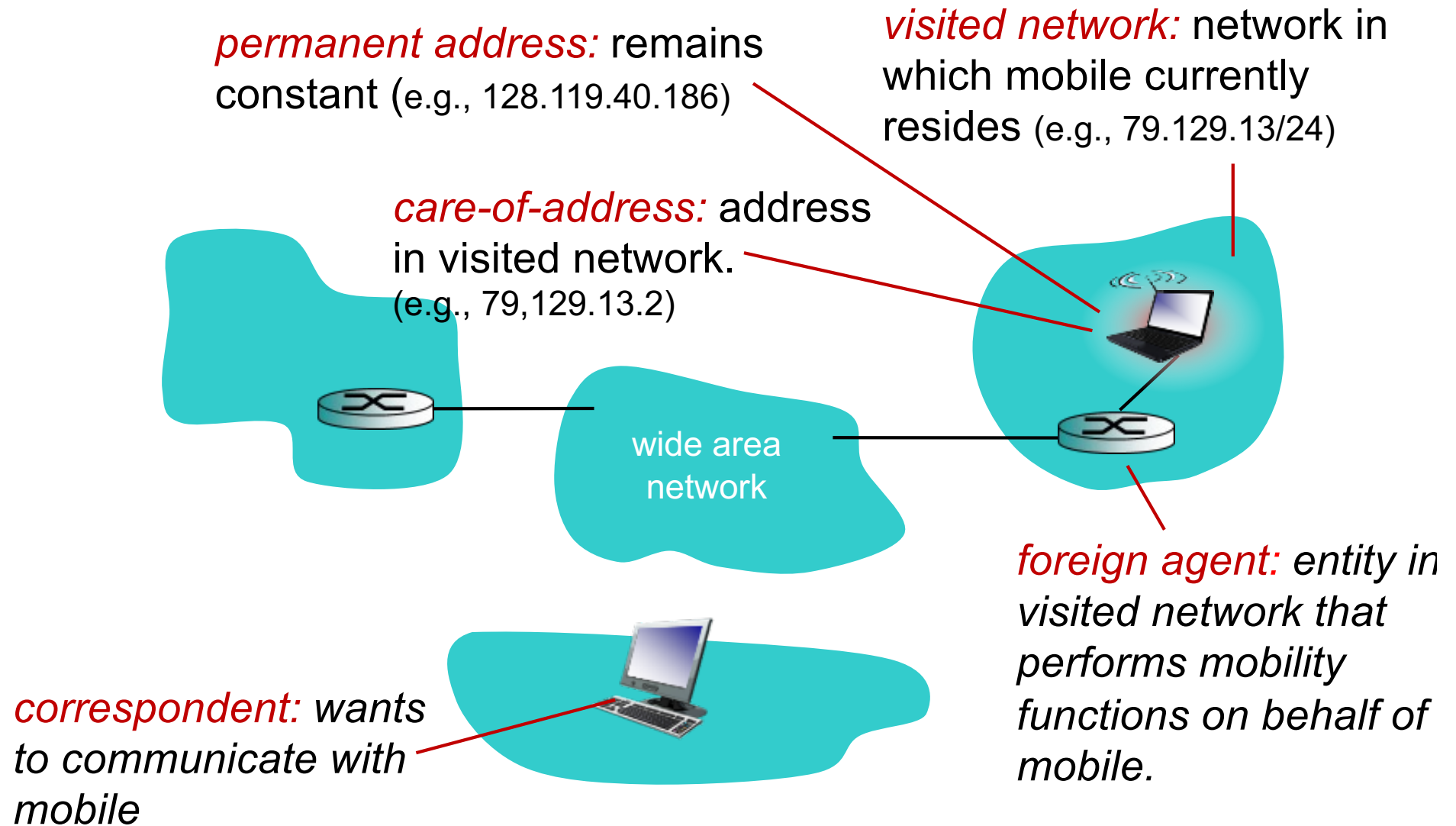
home network: permanent
“home” of mobile
(e.g., 128.119.40/24)

home agent: entity that will
perform mobility functions on
behalf of mobile, when mobile is
remote

permanent address:
address in home
network, *can always* be
used to reach mobile
e.g., 128.119.40.186



Mobility: more vocabulary



Contacting a mobile friend:

Consider friend frequently changing locations, how do you find him/her?

- search all phone books?
- expect her to let you know where he/she is?

- call his/her parents?
- Facebook!

The importance of having a “home”:

- a definitive source of information about you
- a place where people can find out where you are



Mobility approaches

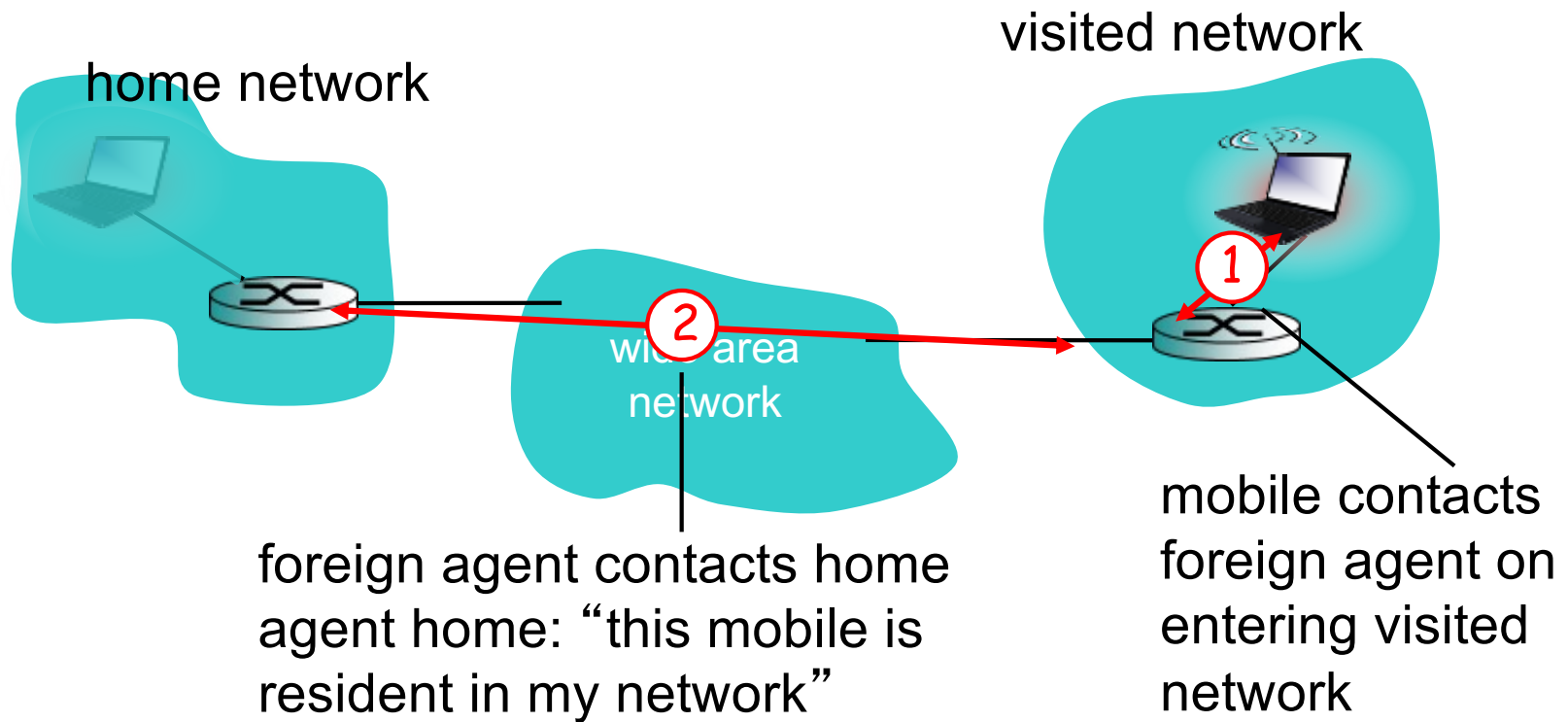
- **let network (routers) handle it:**
 - routers advertise well-known name, address (e.g., permanent 32-bit IP address), or number (e.g., cell #) of visiting mobile node via usual routing table exchange
 - Internet routing could do this already *with no* changes! Routing tables indicate where each mobile located via longest prefix match!

Mobility approaches

- let network (routers) handle it:
 - routers advertise well-known address (e.g., permanent 32-bit IP address), or number (#) of visiting mobile node via usual routing table exchange
 - Internet routing could do this already with *no* changes! Routing tables indicate where each mobile located via longest prefix match!
- **let end-systems handle it:** functionality at the “edge”
 - *indirect routing*: communication from correspondent to mobile goes through home network, then forwarded to remote mobile
 - *direct routing*: correspondent gets foreign address of mobile, send directly to mobile

not
scalable
to billions of
mobiles

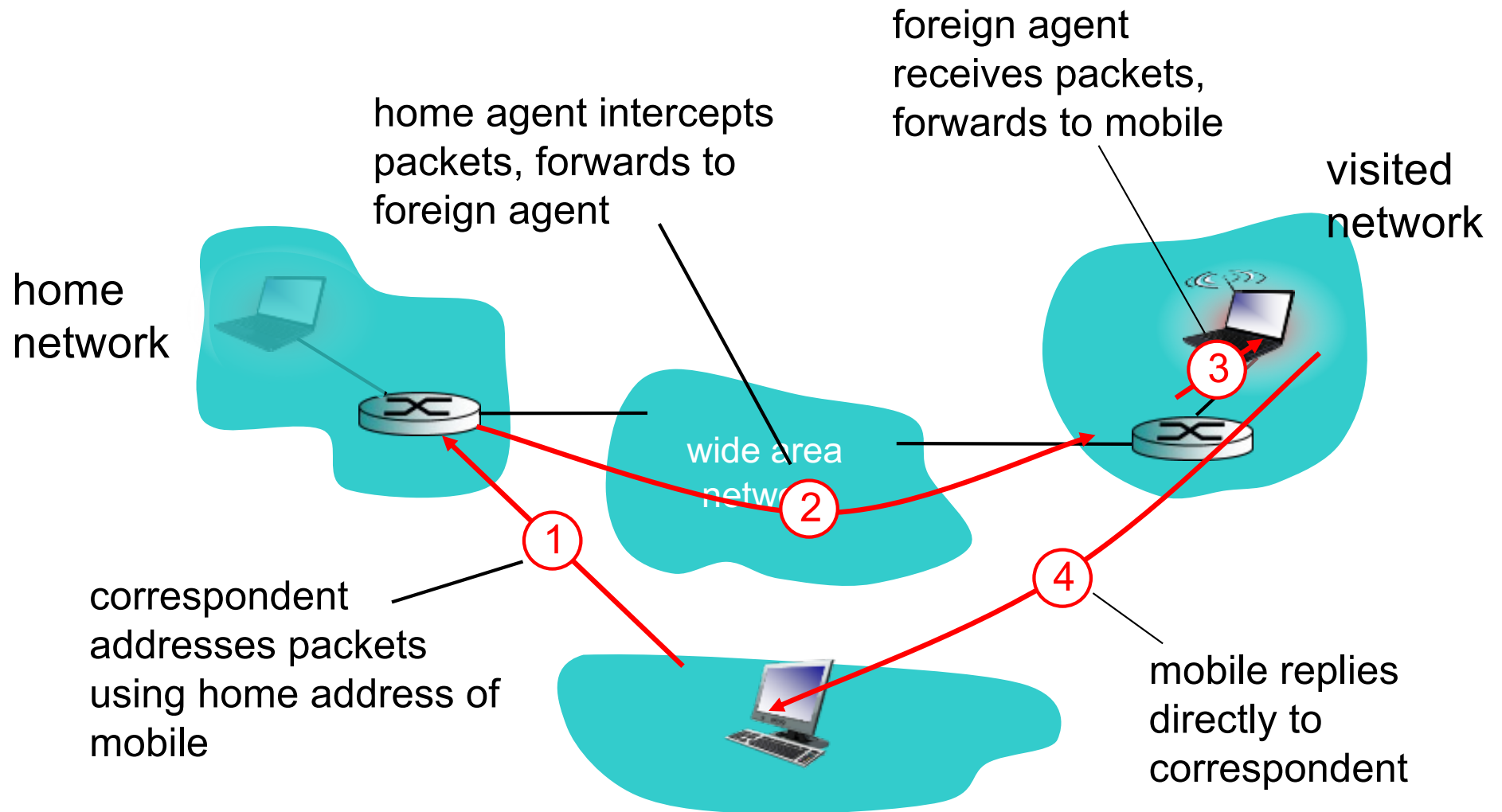
Mobility: registration



end result:

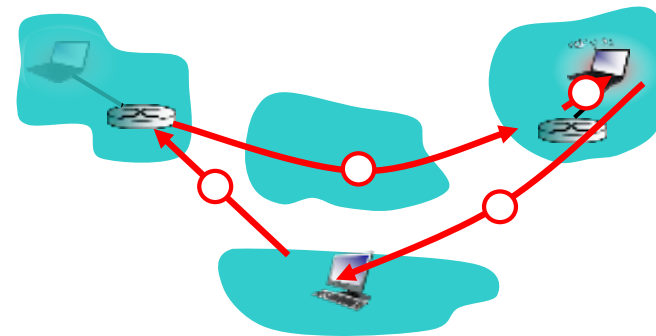
- foreign agent knows about mobile
- home agent knows location of mobile

Mobility via indirect routing



Indirect Routing: comments

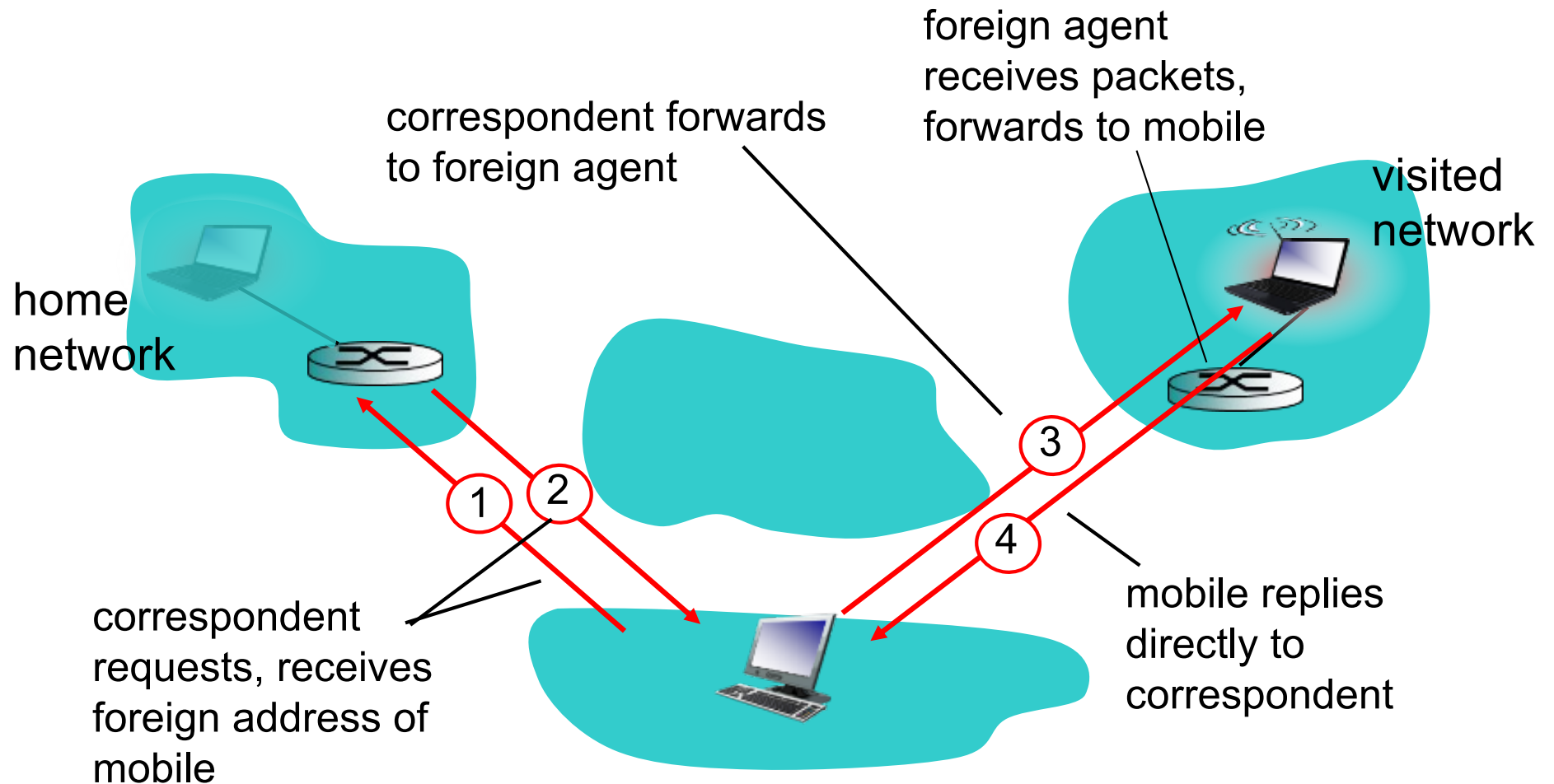
- mobile uses two addresses:
 - **permanent address:** used by correspondent (hence mobile location is *transparent* to correspondent)
 - **care-of-address:** used by home agent to forward datagrams to mobile
- foreign agent functions may be done by mobile itself
- **triangle routing:** correspondent-home-network-mobile
 - inefficient when correspondent, mobile are in same network



Indirect routing: moving between networks

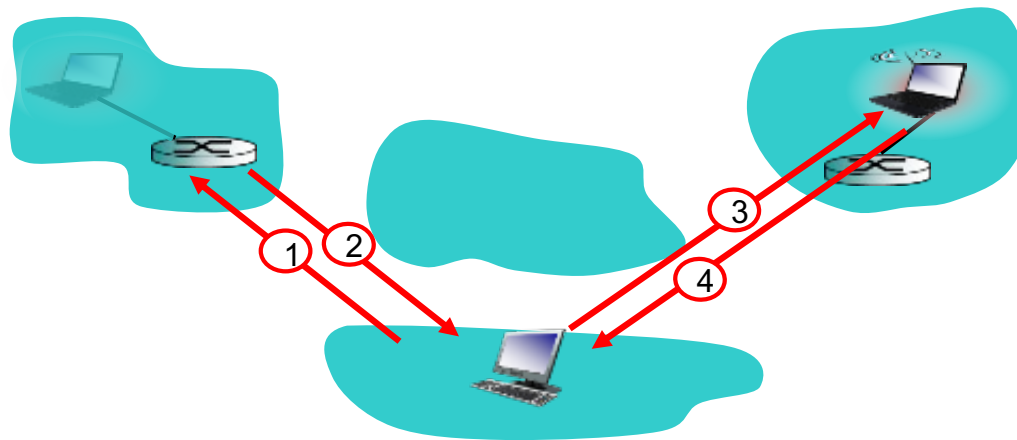
- suppose mobile user moves to another network
 - registers with new foreign agent
 - new foreign agent registers with home agent
 - home agent update care-of-address for mobile
 - packets continue to be forwarded to mobile (but with new care-of-address)
- mobility, changing foreign networks transparent: *on going connections can be maintained!*

Mobility via direct routing



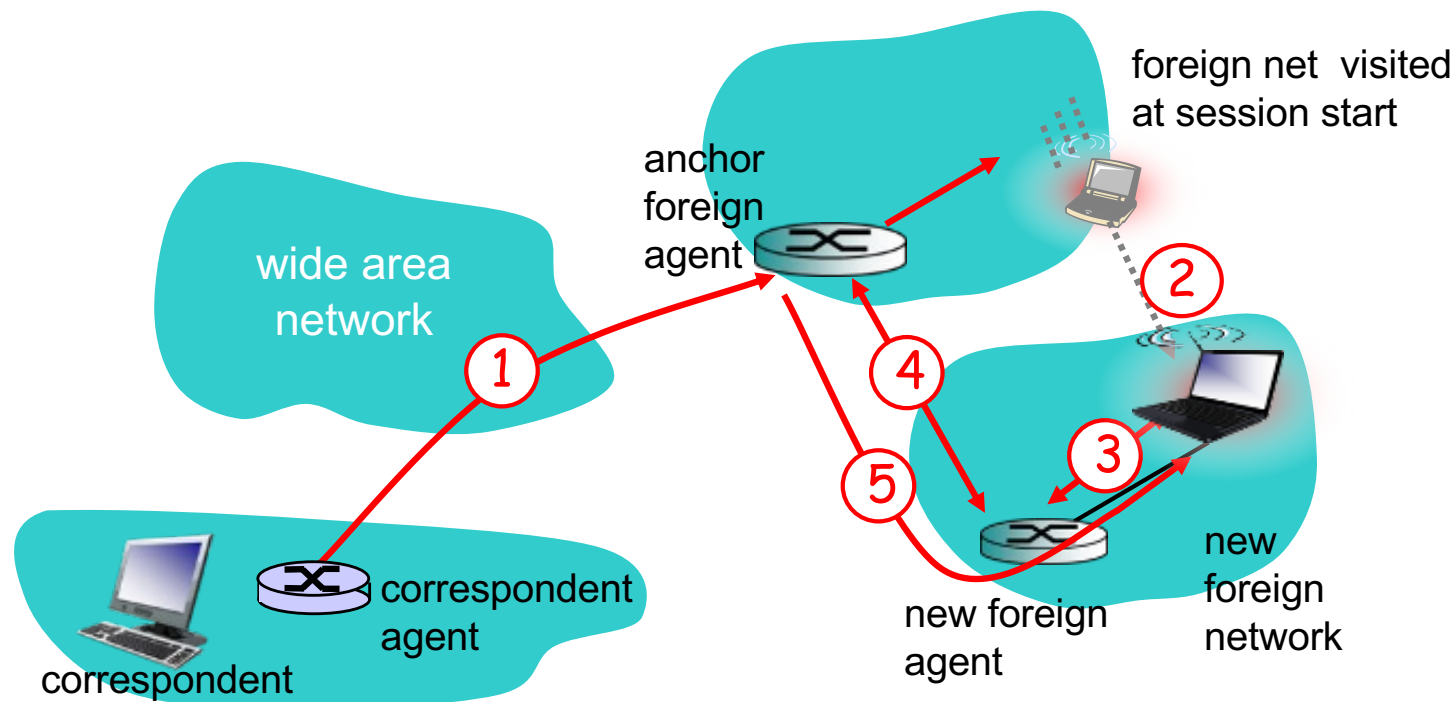
Mobility via direct routing: comments

- overcome triangle routing problem
- *non-transparent to correspondent*: correspondent must get care-of-address from home agent
 - what if mobile changes visited network?



Accommodating mobility with direct routing

- anchor foreign agent: FA in first visited network
- data always routed first to anchor FA
- when mobile moves: new FA arranges to have data forwarded from old FA (chaining)



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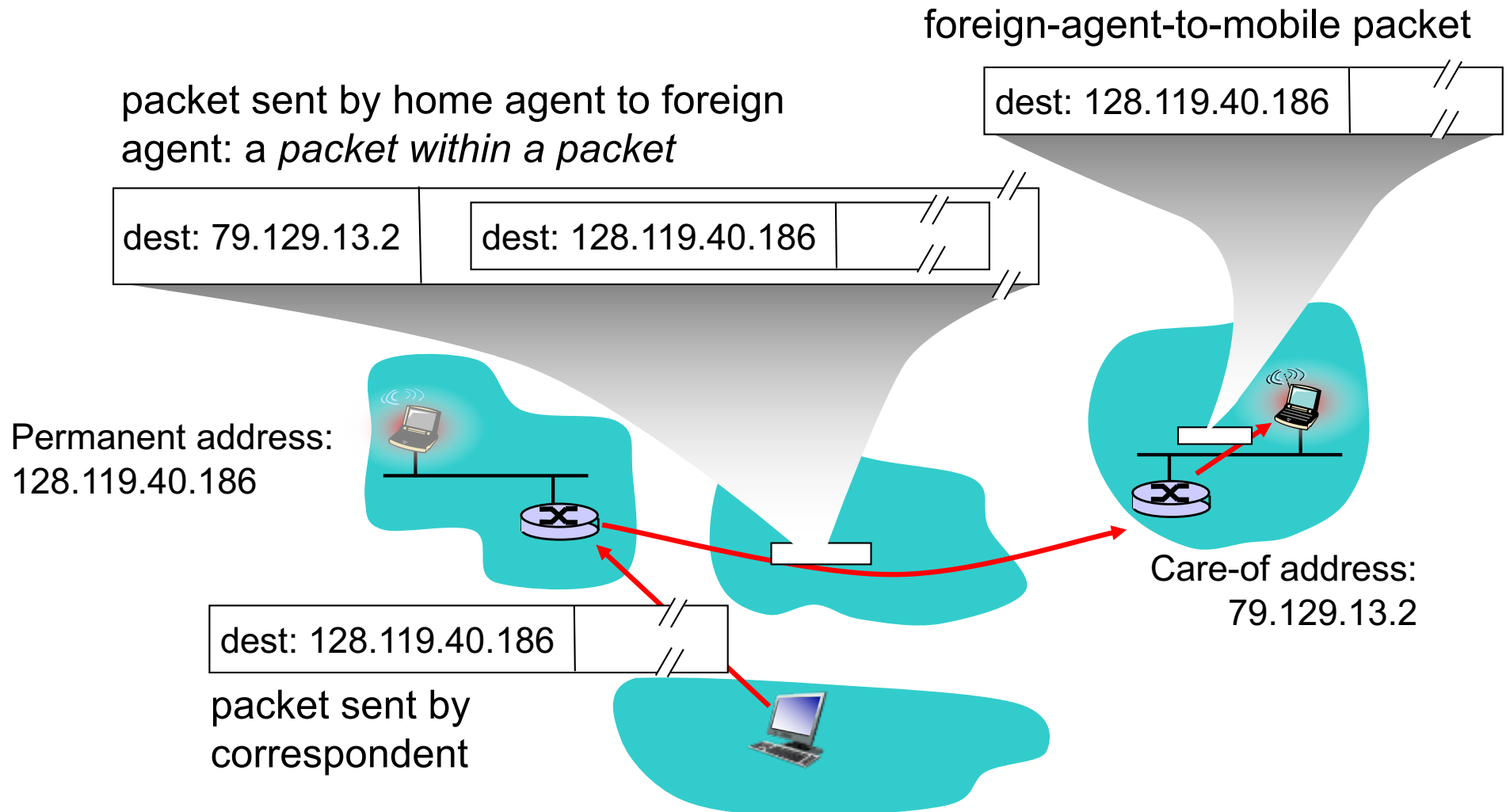
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Mobile IP

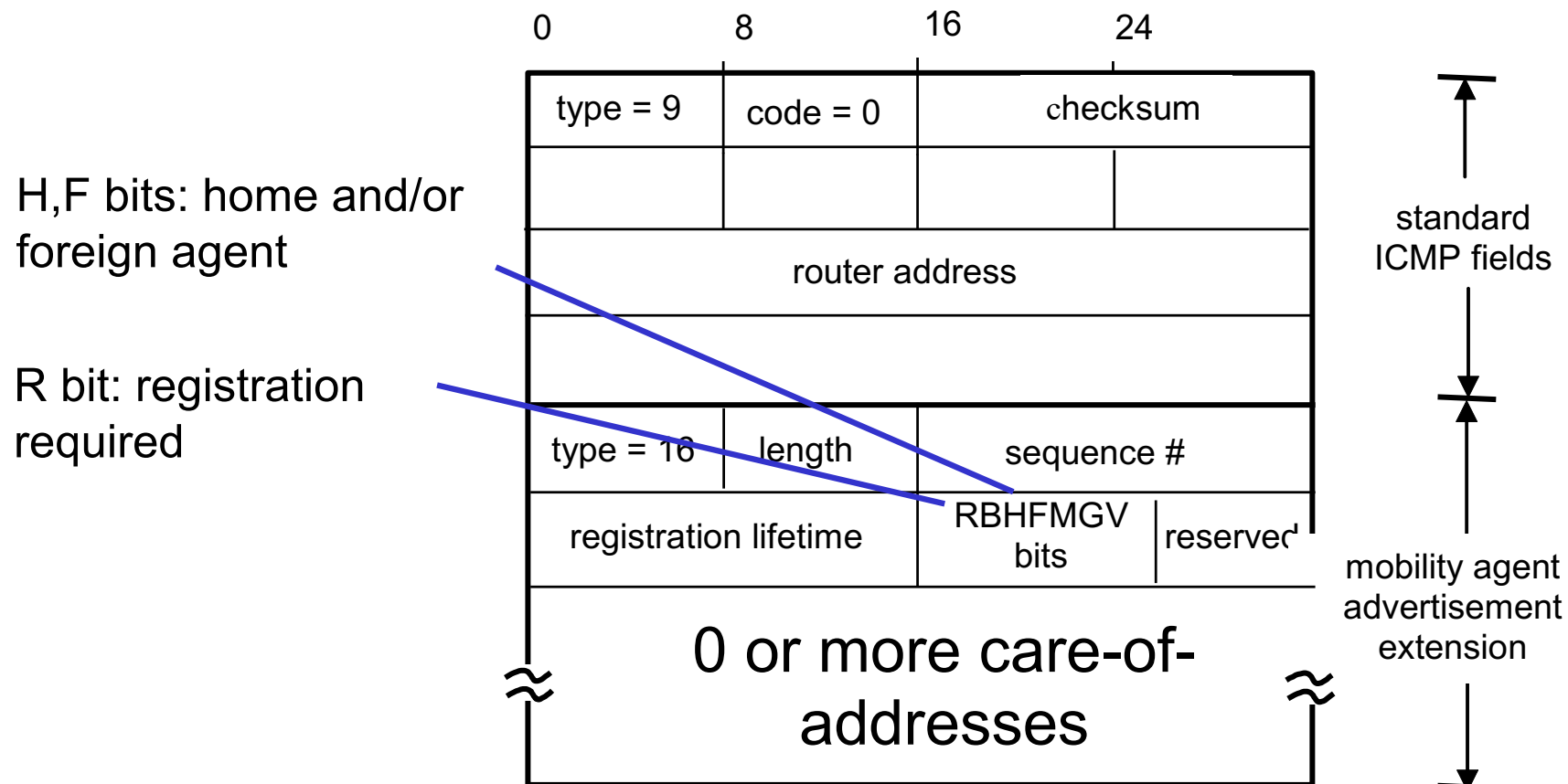
- RFC 3344
- has many features we've seen:
 - home agents, foreign agents, foreign-agent registration, care-of-addresses, encapsulation (packet-within-a-packet)
- three components to standard:
 - indirect routing of datagrams
 - agent discovery
 - registration with home agent

Mobile IP: indirect routing

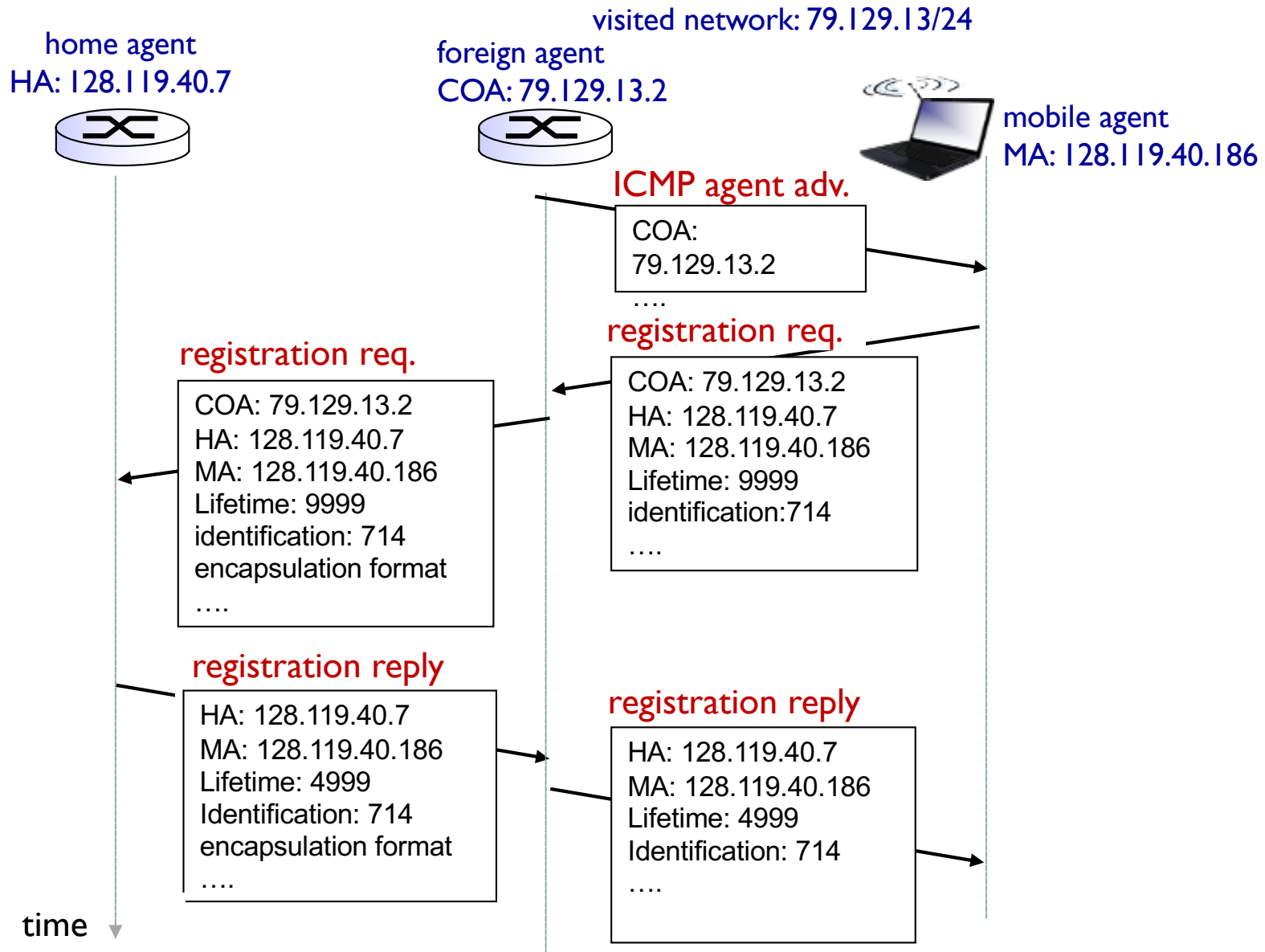


Mobile IP: agent discovery

- *agent advertisement*: foreign/home agents advertise service by broadcasting ICMP messages (typefield = 9)

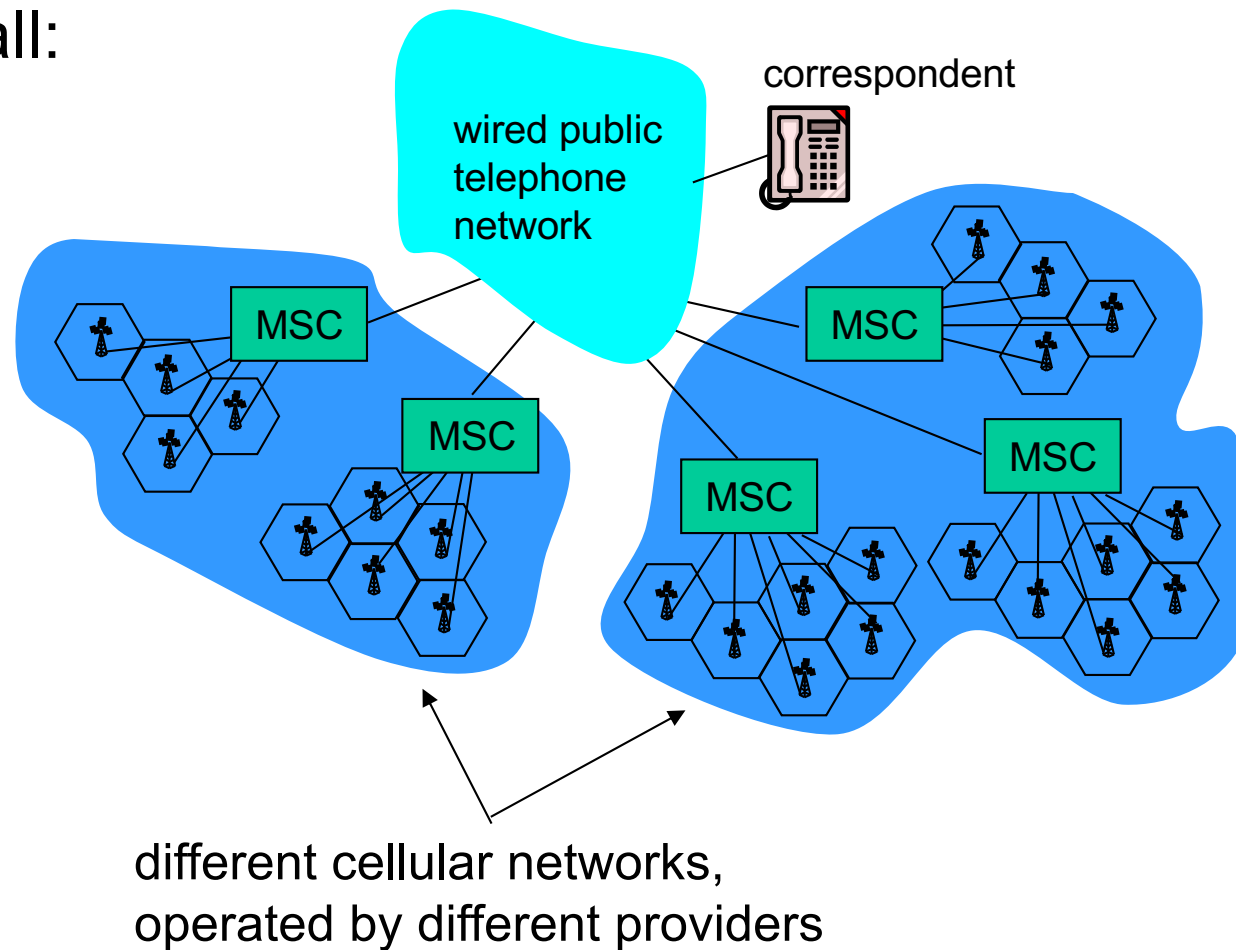


Mobile IP: registration example



Components of cellular network architecture

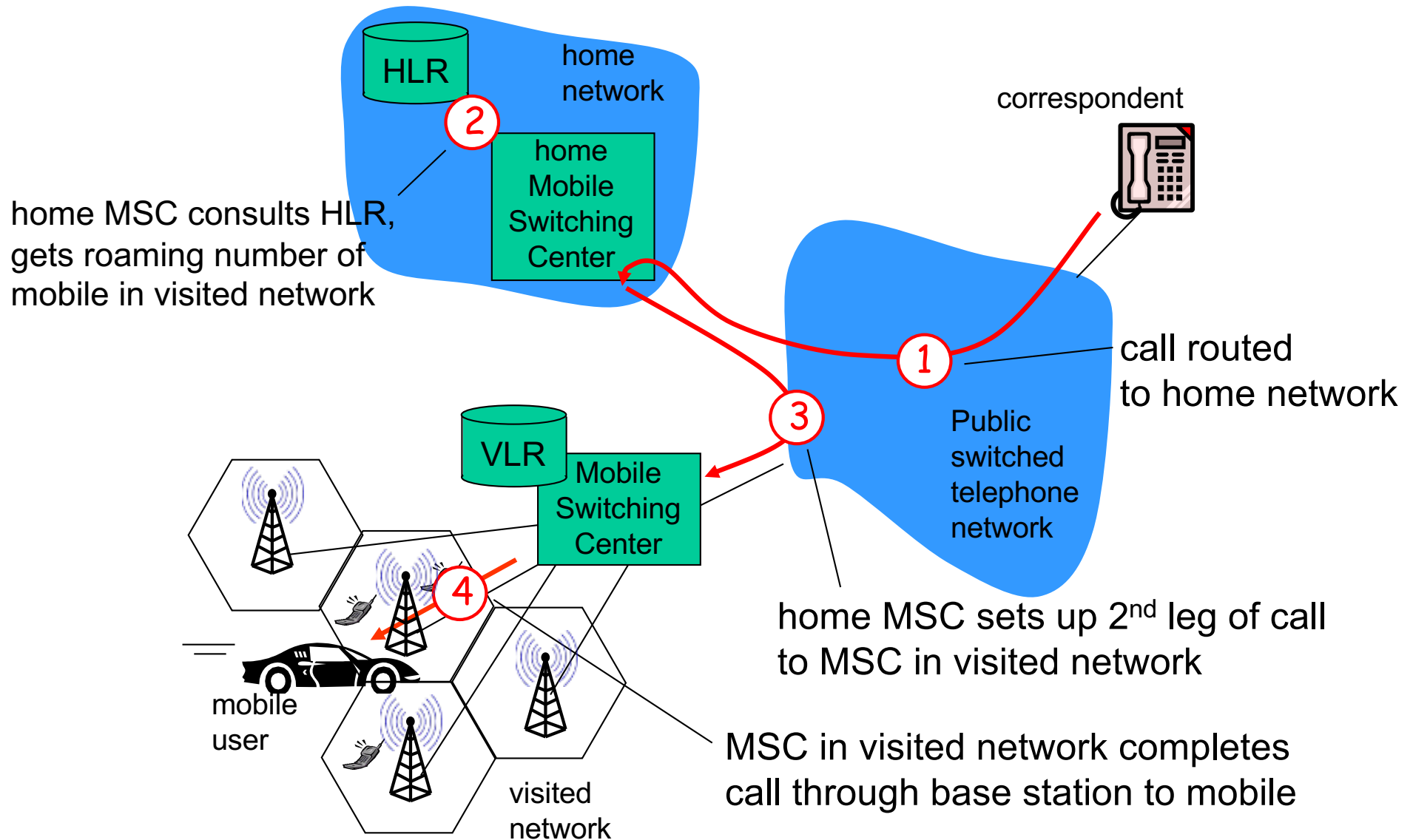
recall:



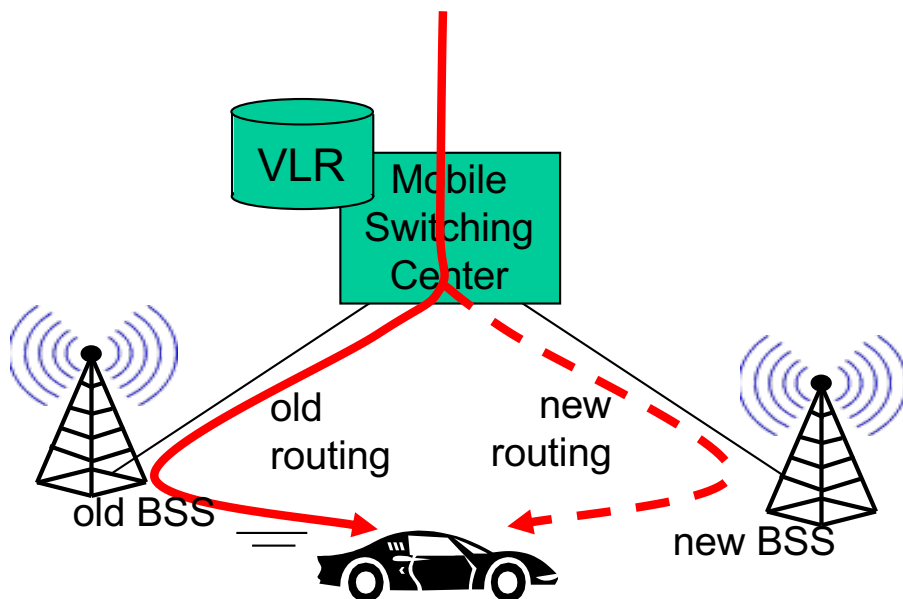
Handling mobility in cellular networks

- *home network*: network of cellular provider you subscribe to (e.g., Sprint PCS, Verizon)
 - *home location register (HLR)*: database in home network containing permanent cell phone #, profile information (services, preferences, billing), information about current location (could be in another network)
- *visited network*: network in which mobile currently resides
 - *visitor location register (VLR)*: database with entry for each user currently in network
 - could be home network

GSM: indirect routing to mobile

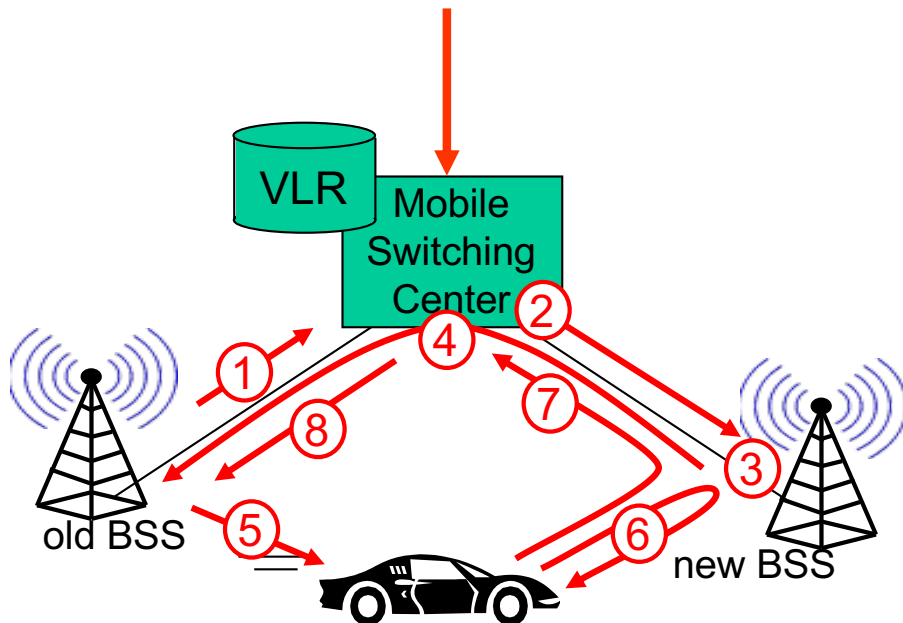


GSM: handoff with common MSC



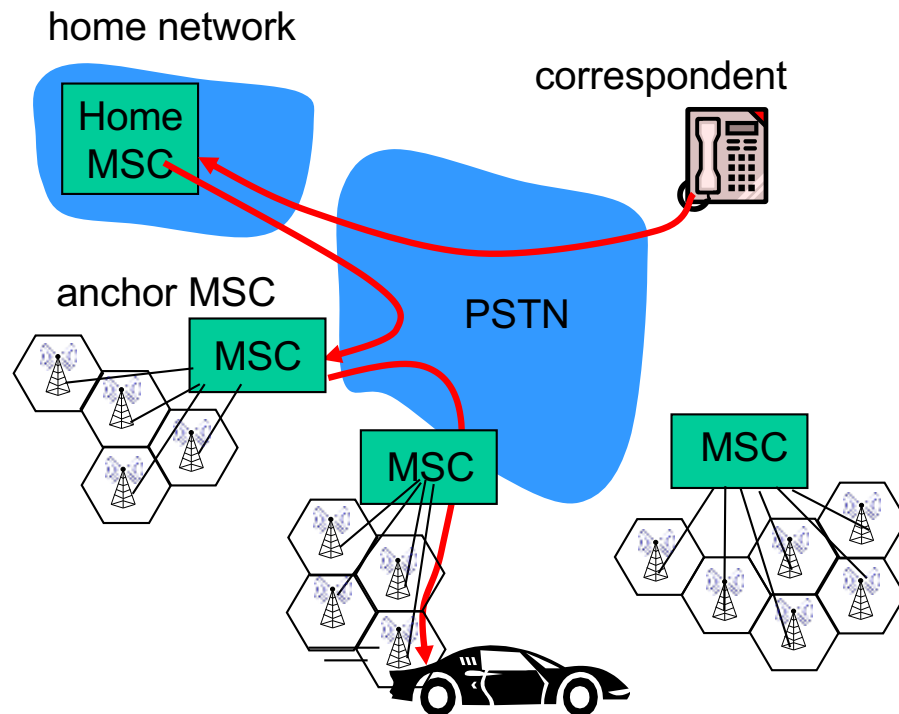
- *handoff goal*: route call via new base station (without interruption)
- reasons for handoff:
 - stronger signal to/from new BSS (continuing connectivity, less battery drain)
 - load balance: free up channel in current BSS
 - GSM doesn't mandate why to perform handoff (policy), only how (mechanism)
- handoff initiated by old BSS

GSM: handoff with common MSC



1. old BSS informs MSC of impending handoff, provides list of 1+ new BSSs
2. MSC sets up path (allocates resources) to new BSS
3. new BSS allocates radio channel for use by mobile
4. new BSS signals MSC, old BSS: ready
5. old BSS tells mobile: perform handoff to new BSS
6. mobile, new BSS signal to activate new channel
7. mobile signals via new BSS to MSC: handoff complete. MSC reroutes call
- 8 MSC-old-BSS resources released

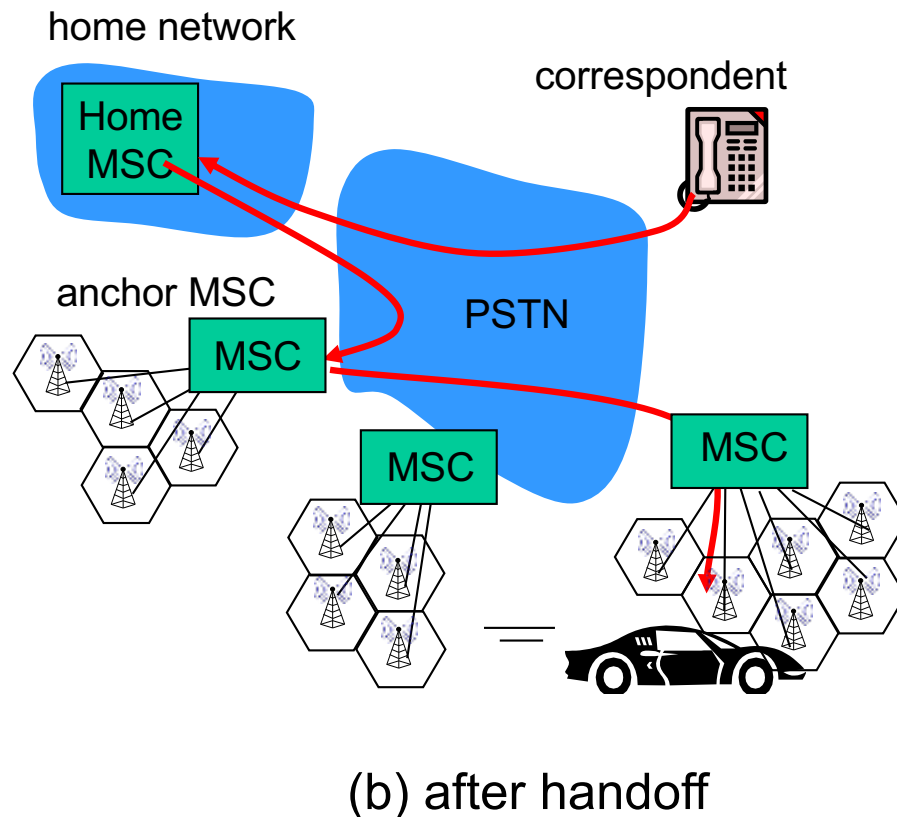
GSM: handoff between MSCs



(a) before handoff

- *anchor MSC*: first MSC visited during call
 - call remains routed through anchor MSC
- new MSCs add on to end of MSC chain as mobile moves to new MSC
- optional path minimization step to shorten multi-MSC chain

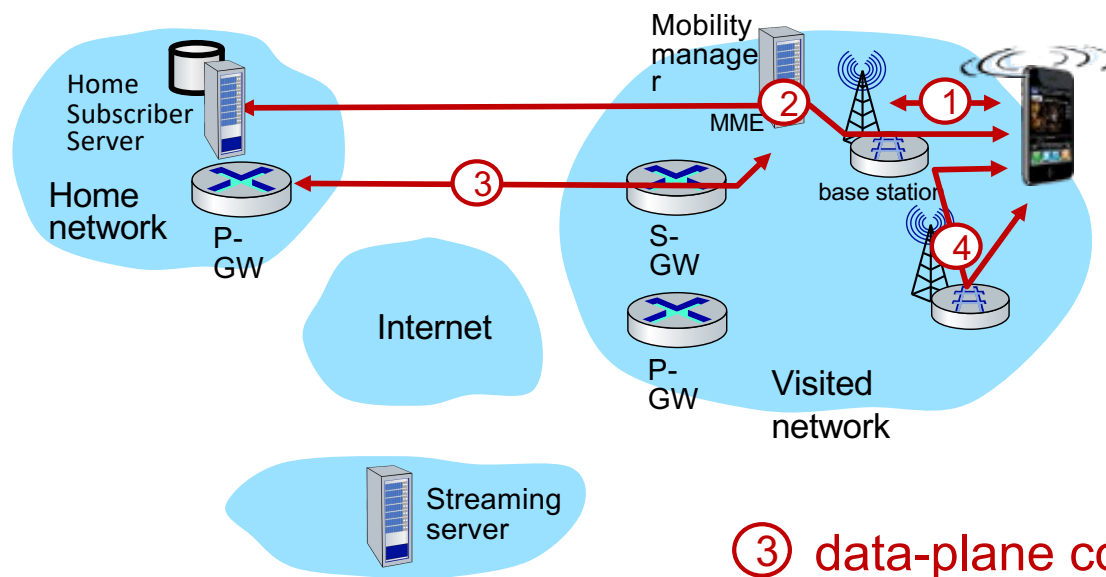
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Mobility in 4G networks: major mobility tasks



① base station association:

- covered earlier
- mobile provides IMSI – identifying itself, home network

② control-plane configuration:

- MME, home HSS establish control-plane state - mobile is in visited network

③ data-plane configuration:

- MME configures forwarding tunnels for mobile
- visited, home network establish tunnels from home P-GW to mobile

④ mobile handover:

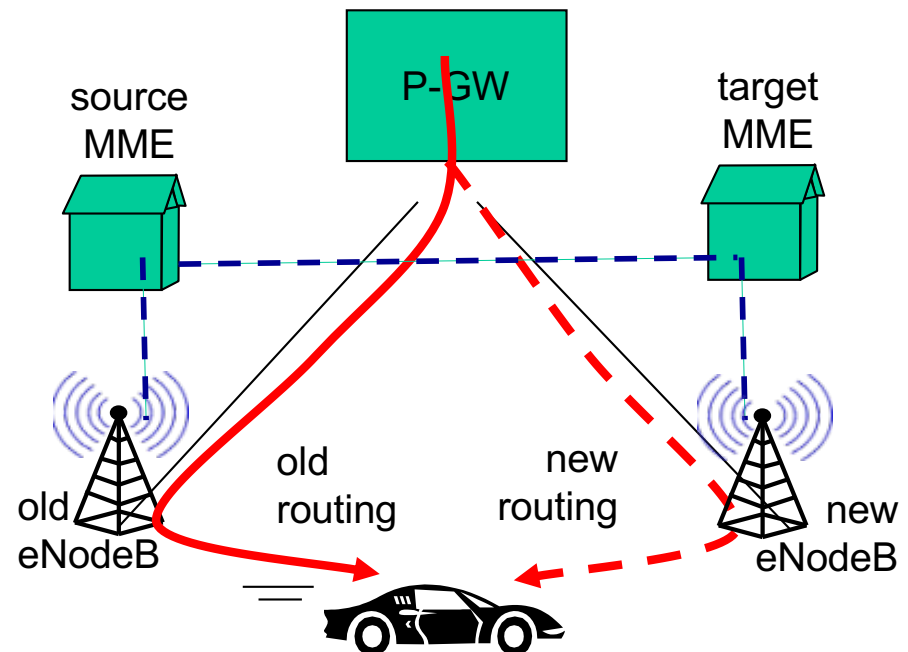
- mobile device changes its point of attachment to visited network

Handling Mobility in LTE

- Paging: idle UE may move from cell to cell: network does not know where the idle UE is resident
 - paging message from MME broadcast by all eNodeB to locate UE

- handoff: similar to 3G:

- preparation phase
- execution phase
- completion phase



Mobility: cellular versus Mobile IP

cellular element	Comment on cellular element	Mobile IP element
Home system	Network to which mobile user's permanent phone number belongs	Home network
Gateway Mobile Switching Center, or "home MSC". Home Location Register (HLR)	Home MSC: point of contact to obtain routable address of mobile user. HLR: database in home system containing permanent phone number, profile information, current location of mobile user, subscription information	Home agent
Visited System	Network other than home system where mobile user is currently residing	Visited network
Visited Mobile services Switching Center. Visitor Location Record (VLR)	Visited MSC: responsible for setting up calls to/from mobile nodes in cells associated with MSC. VLR: temporary database entry in visited system, containing subscription information for each visiting mobile user	Foreign agent
Mobile Station Roaming Number (MSRN), or "roaming number"	Routable address for telephone call segment between home MSC and visited MSC, visible to neither the mobile nor the correspondent.	Care-of-address

Wireless, mobility: impact on higher layer protocols

- logically, impact *should* be minimal ...
 - best effort service model remains unchanged
 - TCP and UDP can (and do) run over wireless, mobile
- ... but performance-wise:
 - packet loss/delay due to bit-errors (discarded packets, delays for link-layer retransmissions), and handoff
 - TCP interprets loss as congestion, will decrease congestion window un-necessarily
 - delay impairments for real-time traffic
 - limited bandwidth of wireless links

Chapter 7 summary

Wireless

- wireless links:
 - capacity, distance
 - channel impairments
 - CDMA
- IEEE 802.11 (“Wi-Fi”)
 - CSMA/CA reflects wireless channel characteristics
- cellular access
 - architecture
 - standards (e.g., 3G, LTE, 4G and 5G)

Mobility

- principles: addressing, routing to mobile users
 - home, visited networks
 - direct, indirect routing
 - care-of-addresses
- case studies
 - mobile IP
 - mobility in GSM, LTE
- impact on higher-layer protocols